ART AS APPROPRIATION & DESTRUCTION

TOPICS

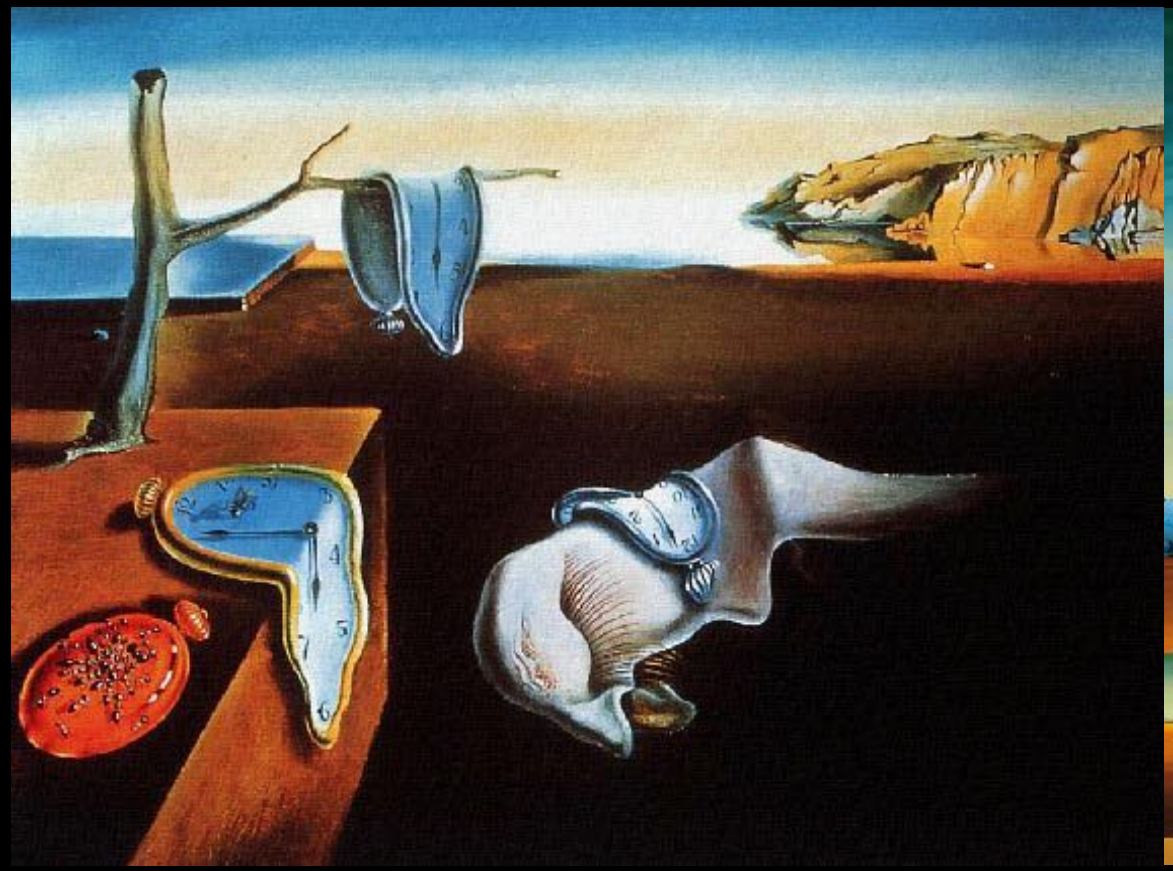
- APPROPRIATION
  - MEDITERRANEAN LEGACY
    THE GREEKS & ROMANS
- DESTRUCTION
  - ICONOCLASM
  - QUESTIONABLE OWNERSHIP

Art & cultural appropriation

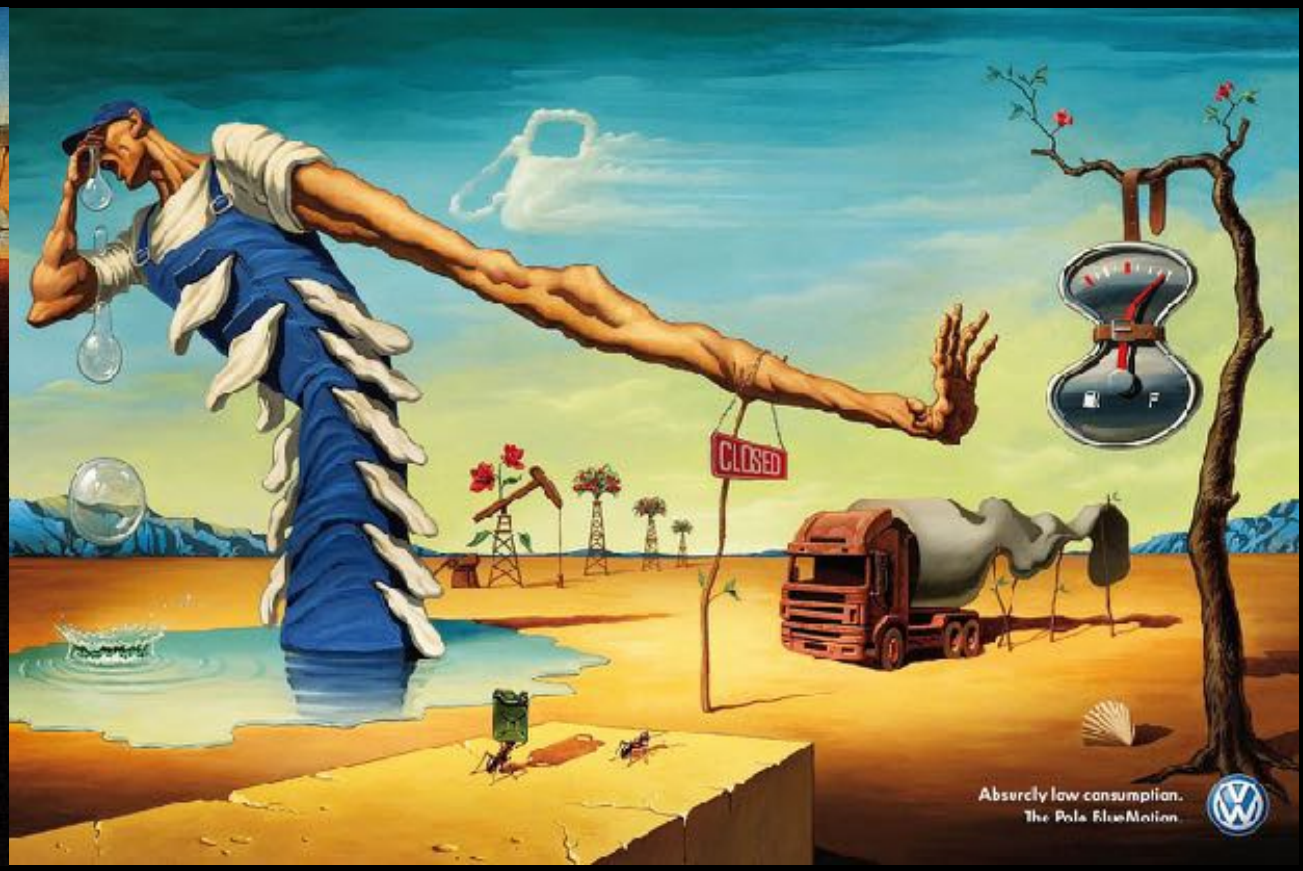
- The use of pre-existing images, ideas, or objects, recontextualized to create new work

Left: LHOOQ | Marcel Duchamp |1919
Right: Mona Lisa | Leonardo Da Vinci | 1503, Florence (Louvre)

INTERMISSION

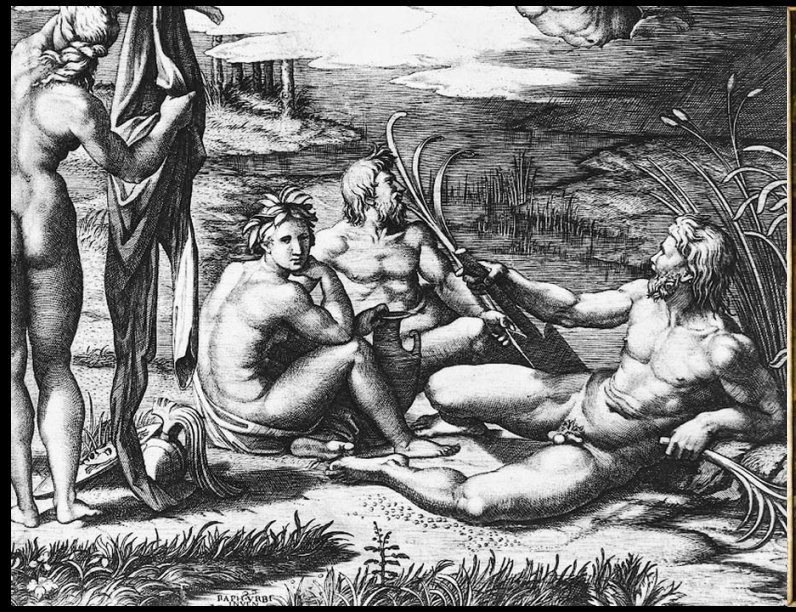


The Persistence of Memory | Salvador Dali | 1931, Figueres (MoMA NY)



Ad by DDB Agency

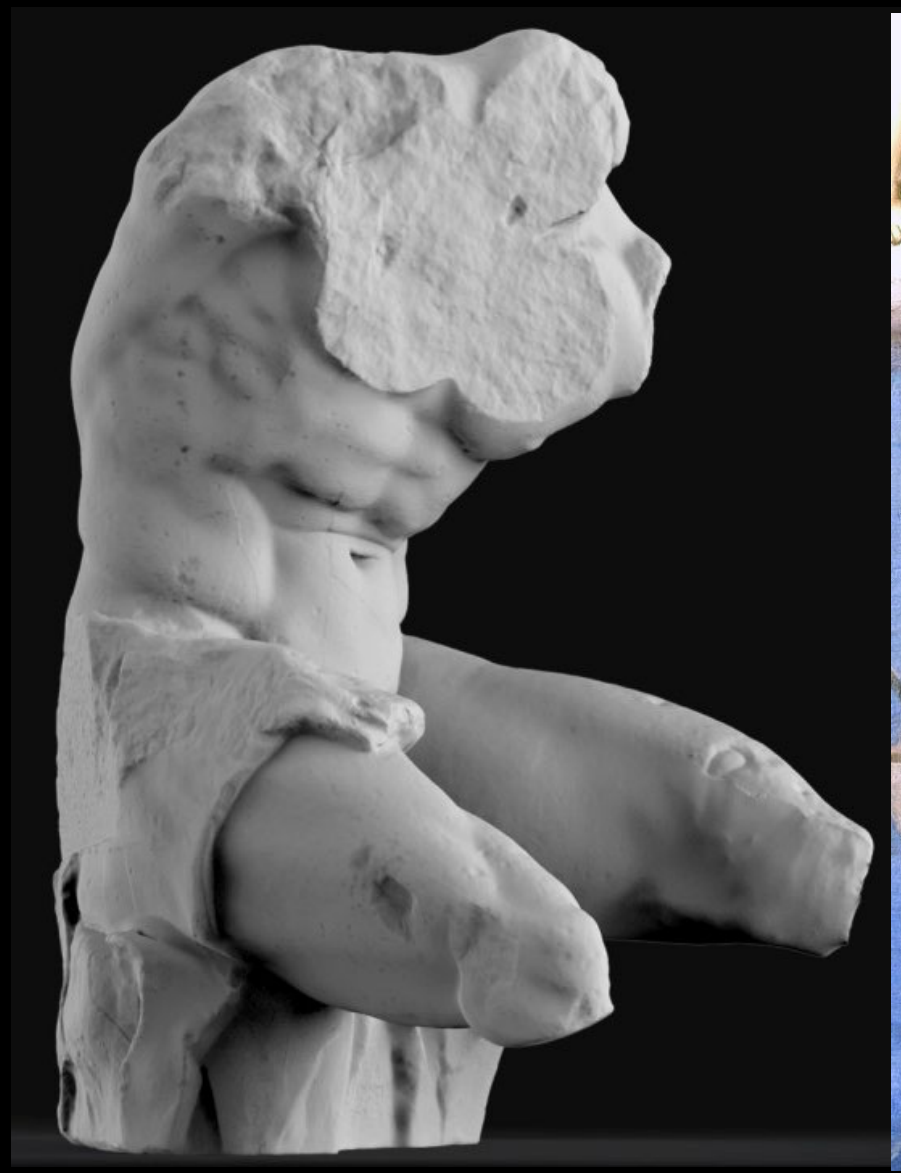
INTERMISSION



detail of Judgement of Paris | Marcantonio Raimondi after Raphael | ca. 1515 (Staatsgalerie Stuttgart)

Le Déjeuner sur l'herbe | Édouard Manet | 1862, Paris (Musée d'Orsay, Paris)

Dior's The Secret Garden Campaign from Raf Simons | 2013



Belvedere Torso | 1st Century BC

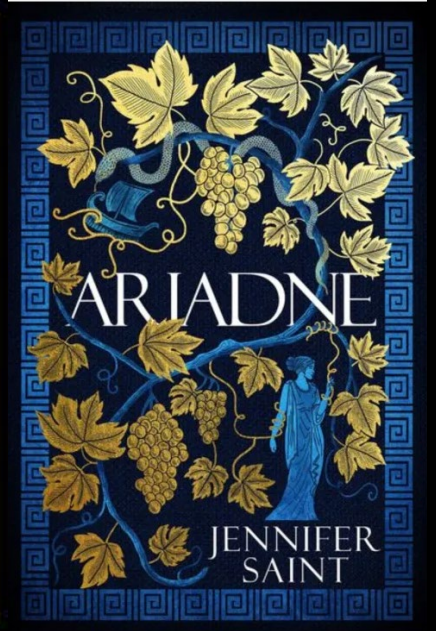
St Bartholomew in The Last Judgement | Michelangelo | ca. 1535 , Rome (Sistine Chapel)

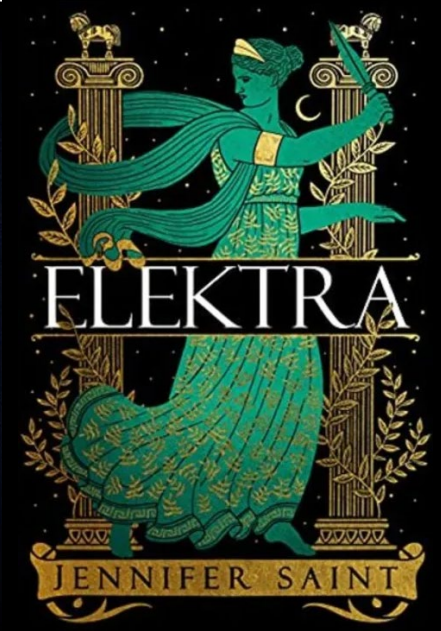
David Beckham in Armani reclame | 2008

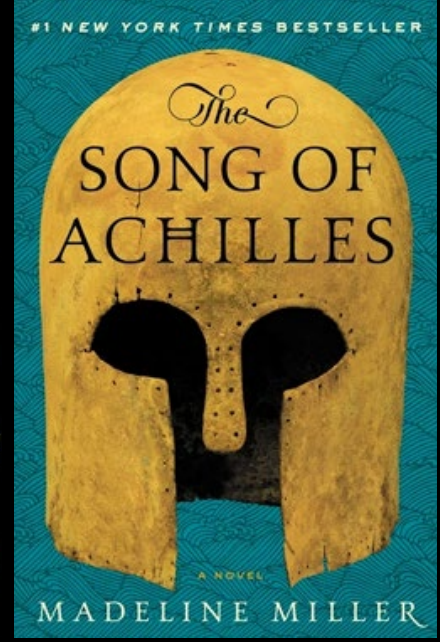
MEDITERRANEAN LEGACY

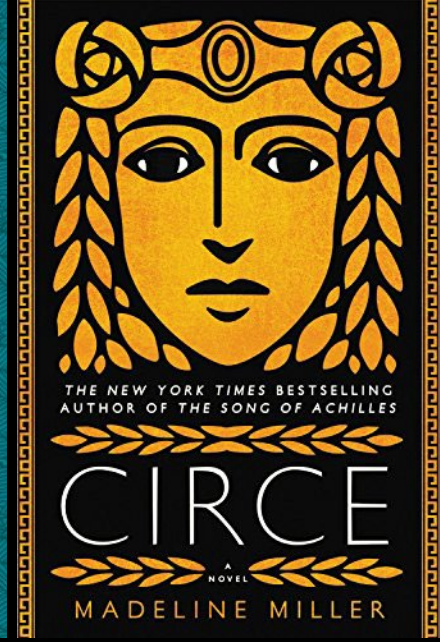
THE GREEKS & ROMANS

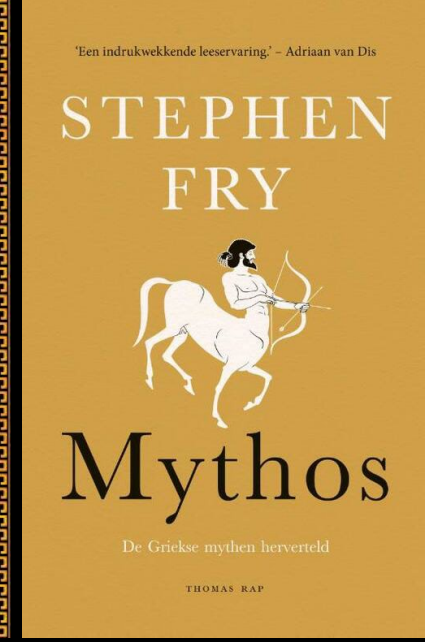
NATALIE HAYNES
A NOVEL
STONE BLIND

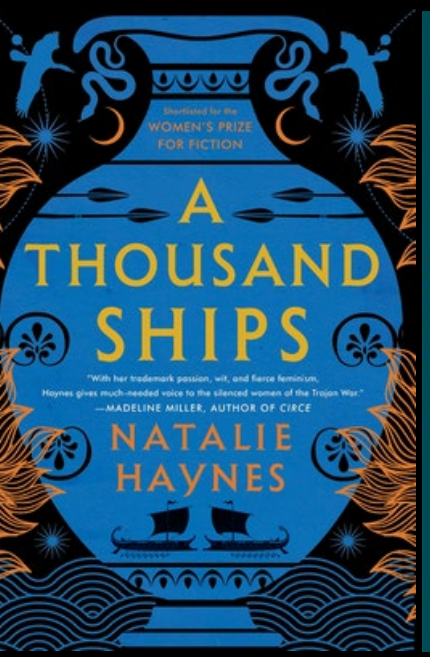

ARIADNE
JENNIFER SAINT

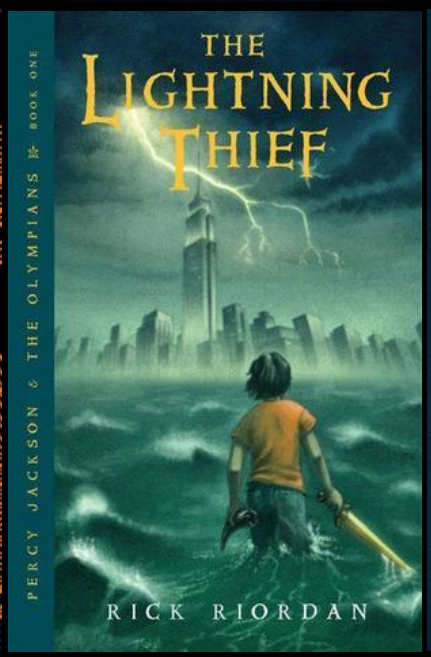

ELEKTRA
JENNIFER SAINT

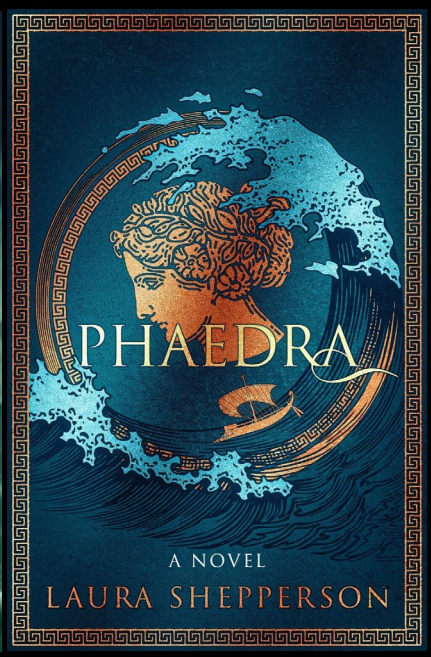

#1 NEW YORK TIMES BESTSELLER
The SONG OF ACHILLES
A NOVEL
MADELINE MILLER

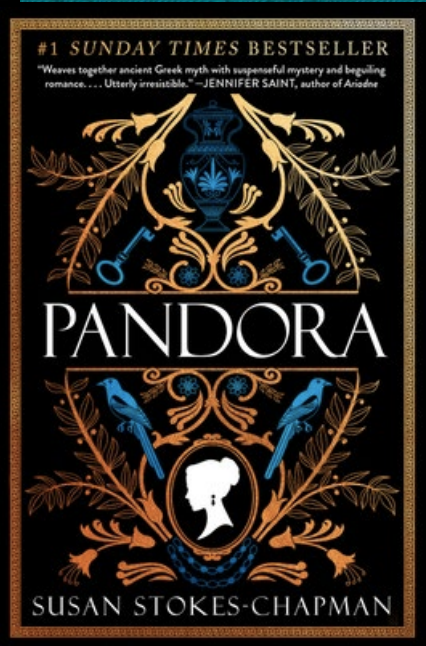

THE NEW YORK TIMES BESTSELLING AUTHOR OF THE SONG OF ACHILLES
CIRCE
A NOVEL
MADELINE MILLER

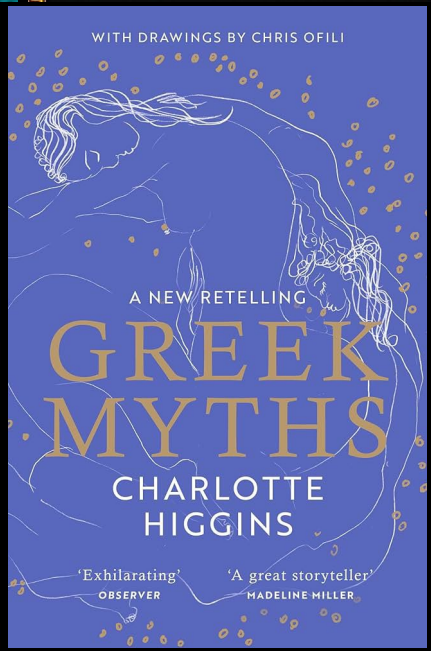

'Een indrukwekkende leeservaring.' – Adriaan van Dis
STEPHEN FRY
Mythos
De Griekse mythen herverteld
THOMAS RAP

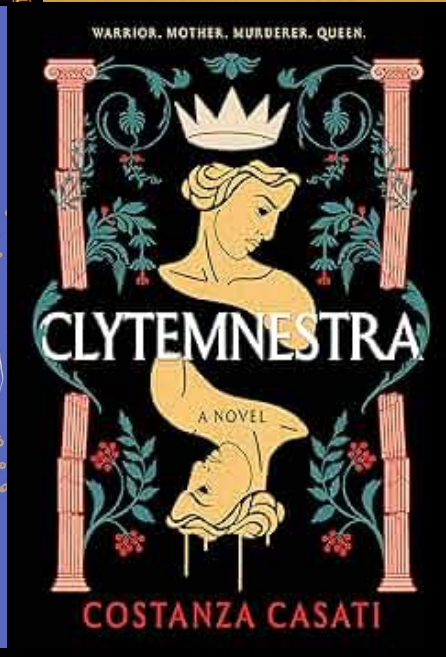

Shortlisted for the WOMEN'S PRIZE FOR FICTION
A THOUSAND SHIPS
"With her trademark passion, wit, and fierce feminism, Haynes gives much-needed voice to the silenced women of the Trojan War."
—MADELINE MILLER, AUTHOR OF CIRCE
NATALIE HAYNES


PERCY JACKSON & THE OLYMPIANS ★ BOOK ONE
THE LIGHTNING THIEF
RICK RIORDAN

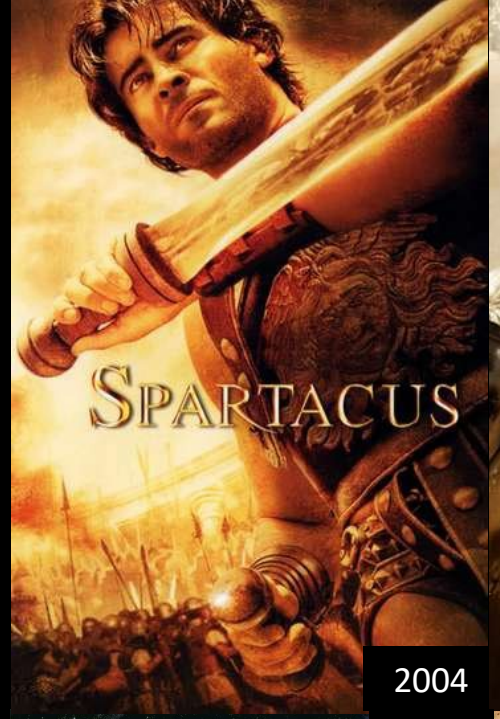

PHAEDRA
A NOVEL
LAURA SHEPPERSON


#1 SUNDAY TIMES BESTSELLER
"Weaves together ancient Greek myth with suspenseful mystery and beguiling romance. . . . Utterly irresistible." —JENNIFER SAINT, author of Ariadne
PANDORA
SUSAN STOKES-CHAPMAN


WITH DRAWINGS BY CHRIS OFILI
A NEW RETELLING
GREEK MYTHS
CHARLOTTE HIGGINS
'Exhilarating'
OBSERVER
'A great storyteller'
MADELINE MILLER


WARRIOR. MOTHER. MURDERER. QUEEN.
CLYTEMNESTRA
A NOVEL
COSTANZA CASATI

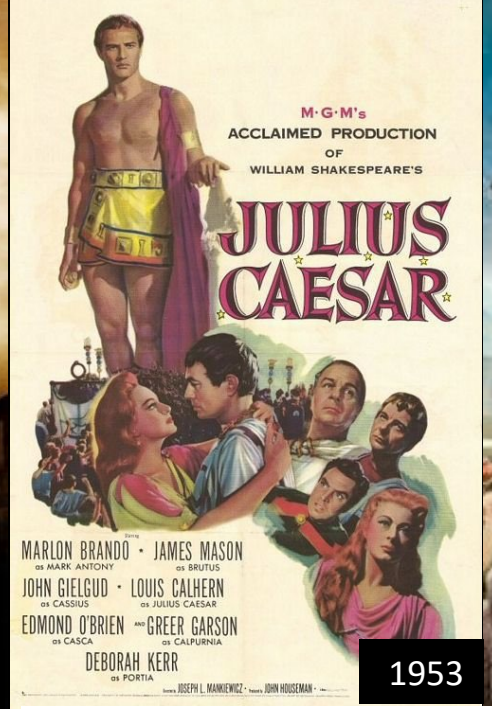
INTERMISSION



2004

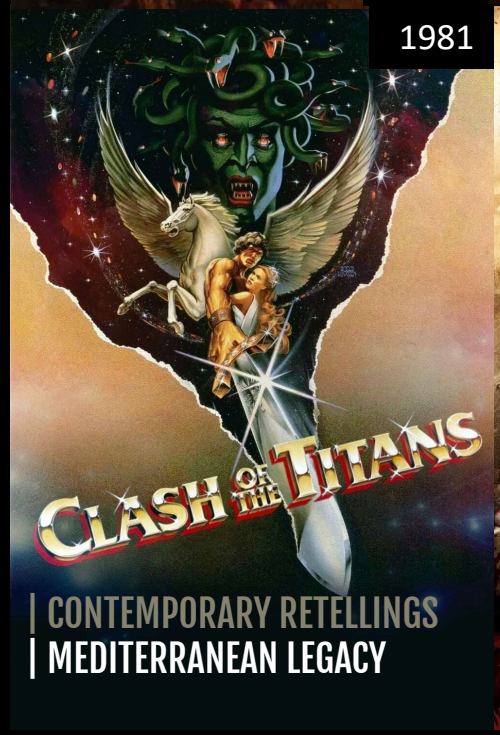
2016

2000



1953

2023



1981

| CONTEMPORARY RETELLINGS
| MEDITERRANEAN LEGACY

2006

2004

1997

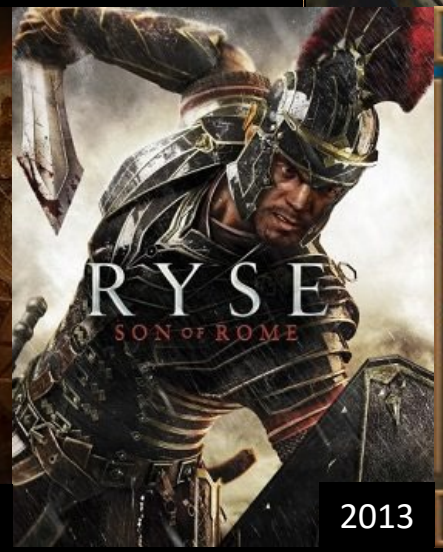
2012

INTERMISSION

Age of Empire:The Rise of Rome (1998)

Assassin's Creed Odyssey (2018)

2013



2013

2022

before the Greeks and
the Romans, there was…

1 | ANCIENT MEDITERRANEAN

↓

The sea provided routes for food, trade, colonization, and war throughout the ages

Knossos on Crete aka “the first city of Europe” | 1950 - 1800 BC

Minoan culture

ca. 3100 BC – ca. 1100 BC | Crete

- Open trading community
- Monumental architecture
- Colourful motifs
  from nature and ritual
- No depth / perspective
- Indication of movement
  but still static and stiff

Reconstruction of Dolphin (top) and fresco Bull-leaping (bottom) frescos | ca. 1450 BC, Knossos (Archaeological Museum Heraklion)

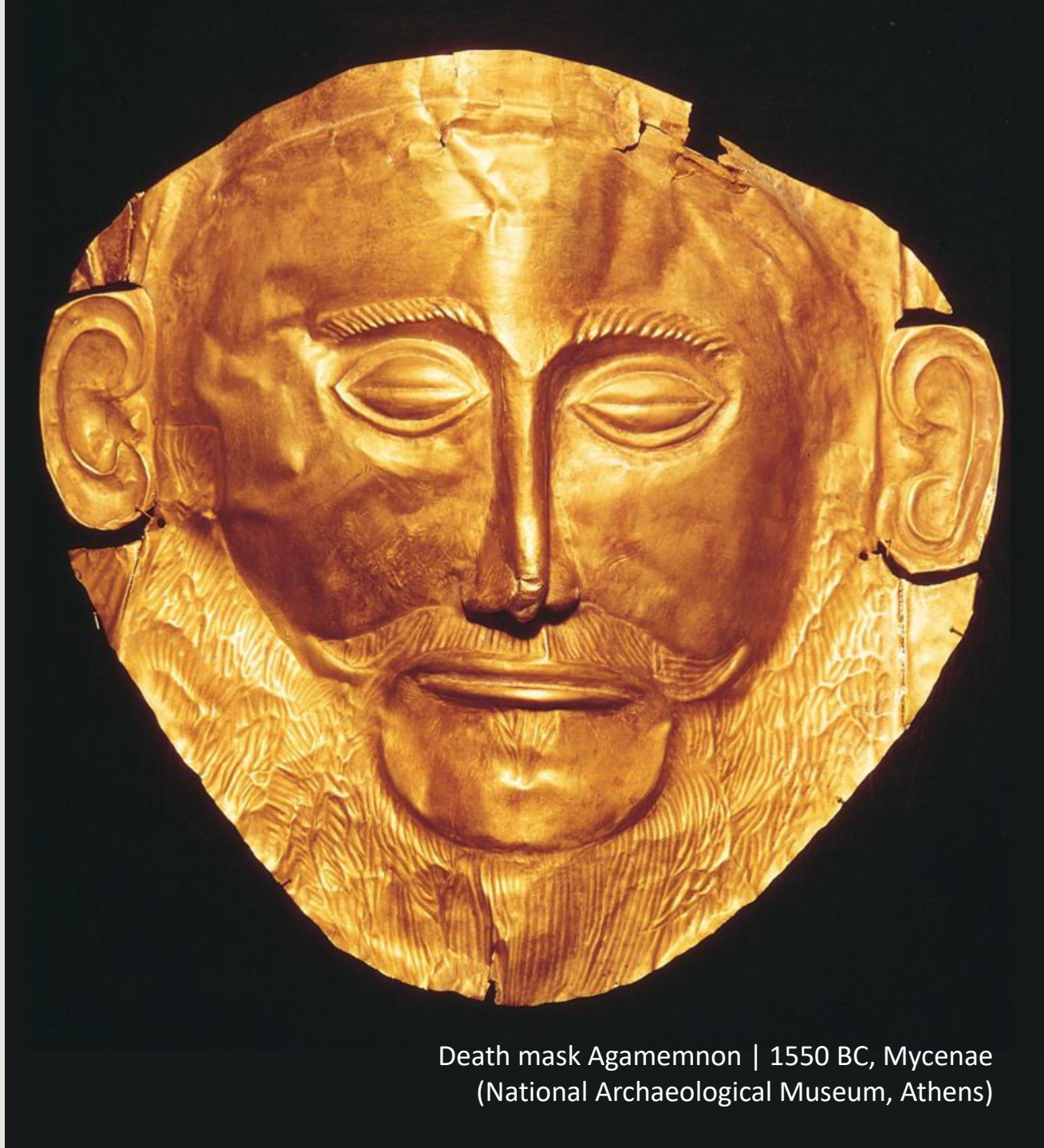
Warrior Vase | 12th c. BC, Mycenae
(Nat. Archaeological Museum, Athens)

Lion Gate and cyclopean masonry (right) | 1250 BC, Mycenae

Mycenaean culture

ca. 1750 BC – ca. 1050 BC | Greek mainland

- Warrior elite society
- Centrally organized palace states with a king
- Linear B script
- Pre-Olympic religion
- Setting for ancient Greek literature and mythology



Death mask Agamemnon | 1550 BC, Mycenae
(National Archaeological Museum, Athens)

Triad statue of pharaoh Menkaura | ca. 2500 BC (Egyptian Museum Cairo)

Mask of Tutankhamun | ca. 1323 BC, Valley of the Kings in Luxor (Egyptian Museum Cairo)

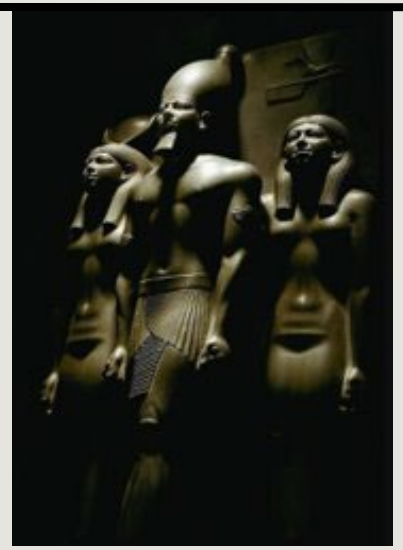
Nefertiti Bust | Thutmose | 1345 BC, Amarna (Neues Museum Berlin)

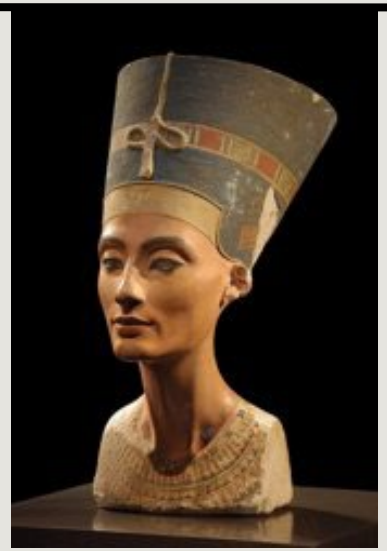
Ancient Egyptian culture

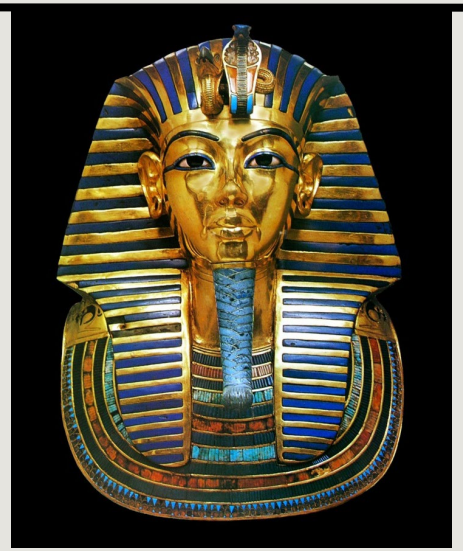
- Successful agriculture in Nile valley
  predictable flooding and irrigation systems
  surplus crops → denser population
  → social and culture development
- Unified bureaucracy with pharoah as unifying factor / at the top
- Collective construction projects
  monumental pyramids, temples, obelisks,…
- Independent writing system
- Elaborate system of religious beliefs

Narmer Palette | 31st c. – 30th c. BC,
Hierakonpolis (Egyptian Museum, Cairo)

GREEK ART







2 | GREEKS & ROMANS

CA. 800 BC. – 476 | MEDITERRANEAN SEA

Timeline of Greek art

Archaic Period

ca. 800 BC - 480 BC

Persian Wars

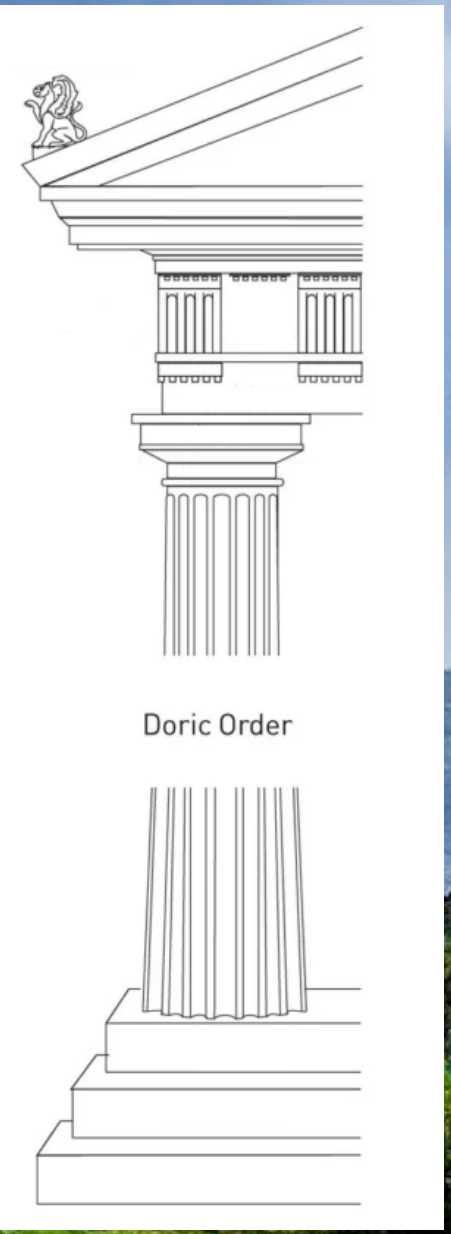
499 BC - 448 BC

Archaïc period

- Less rigid stylization
- “Archaic smile”
- More naturalistic / attention to human proportion and anatomy
- Development of Doric and Ionic orders of architecture

Left: Koré
Right: Kouros

"the best preserved of all Greek temples"



Second temple of Hera | ca. 450 BC, Paestum

Classical period

448 BC - 323 BC

Death of
Alexander the Great
323 BC

detail of *Alexander Mosaic* |
ca. 100 BC, House of the Faun (Pompeii)

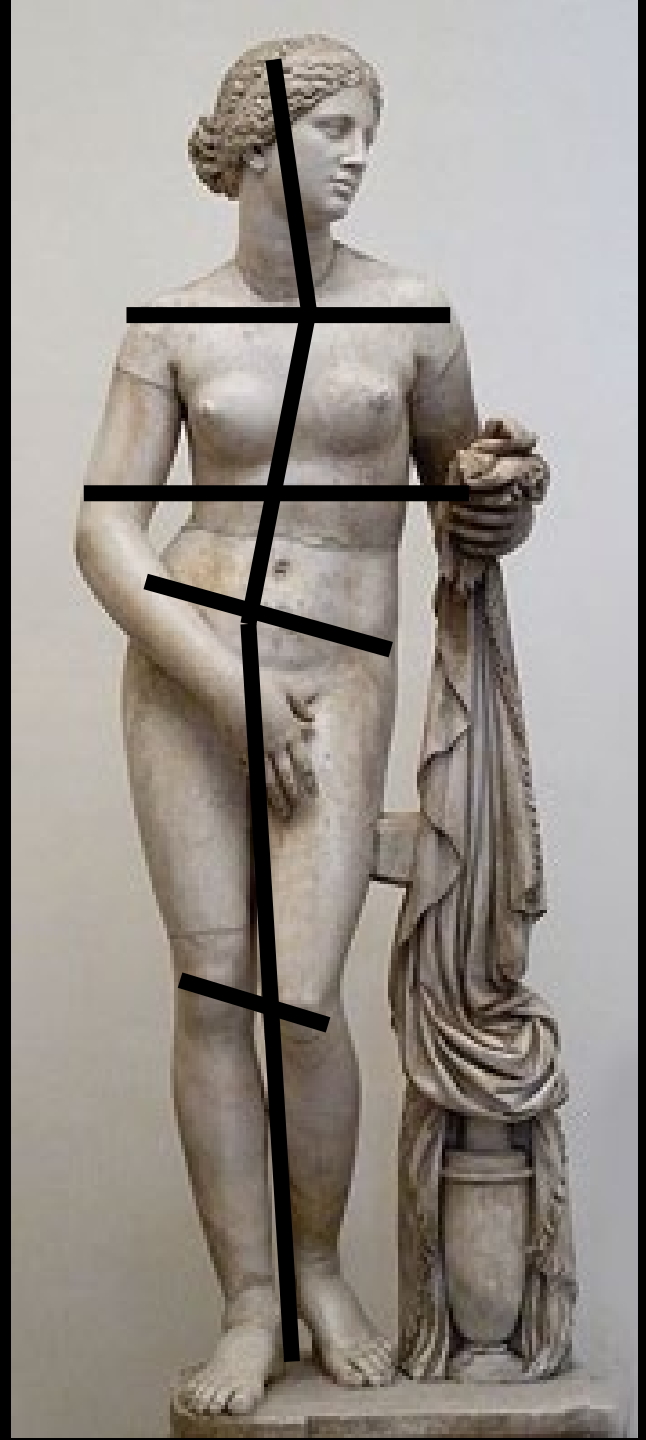
Classical period

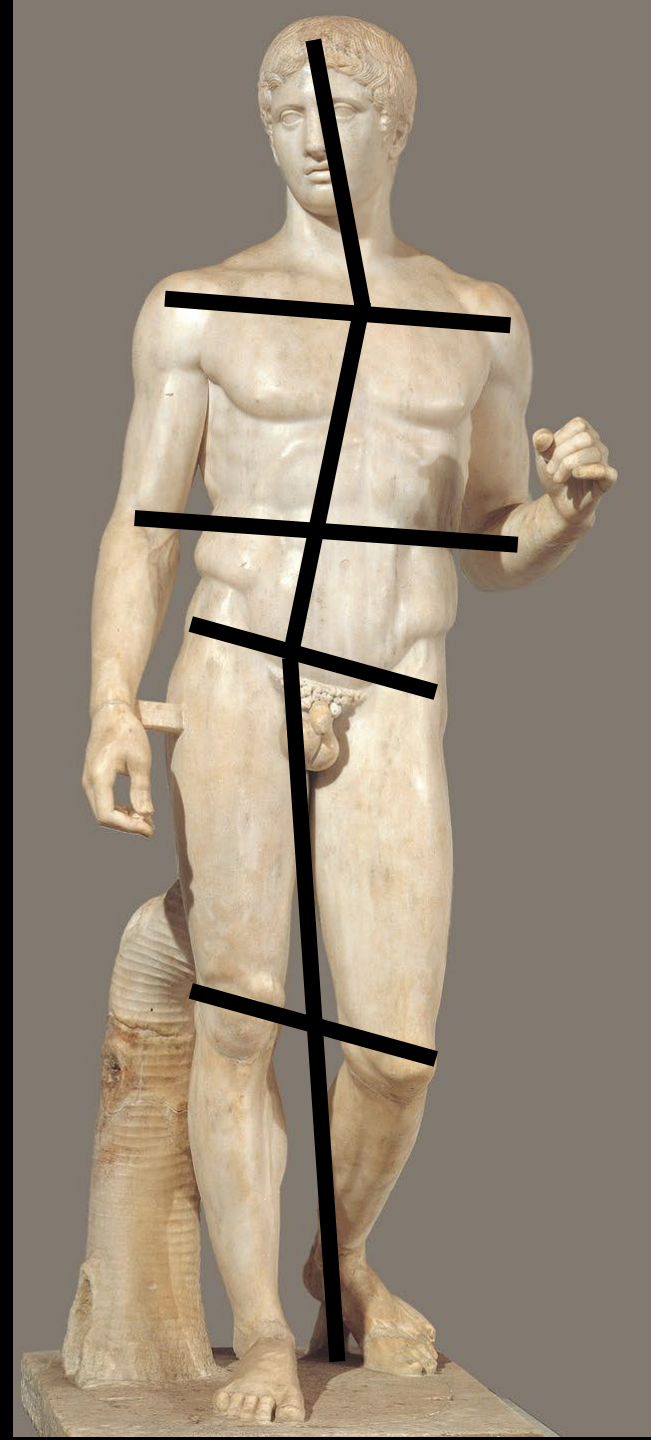
- Increase technical skills depicting realistic bodies
- Natural poses and ideaistic human forms
- Sculpture as building decoration

Left: marble copy of *Aphrodite of Knidus* | Praxiteles | 4th c. BC
Right: marble copy of *Doryphoros* | Polykleitos | 120 - 50 BC, Pompeii

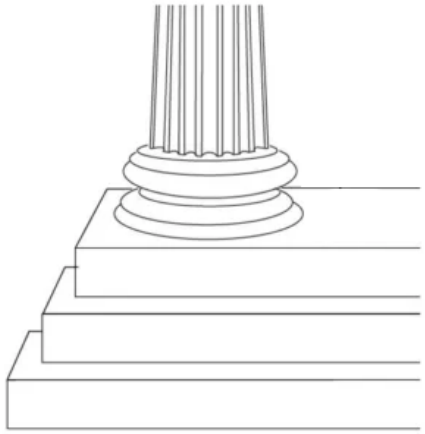
Contrapposto

- Human figure with most of its weight on one foot, so shoulders and arms twist off-axis from hips and legs
- First time human body is used to express psychological disposition in early 5th c. BC, Greece
- Subtle S-curve → more dynamic, more natural appearance





Ionic Order



Temple of Athena Nike| Kallikrates | ca. 420 BC, Athens

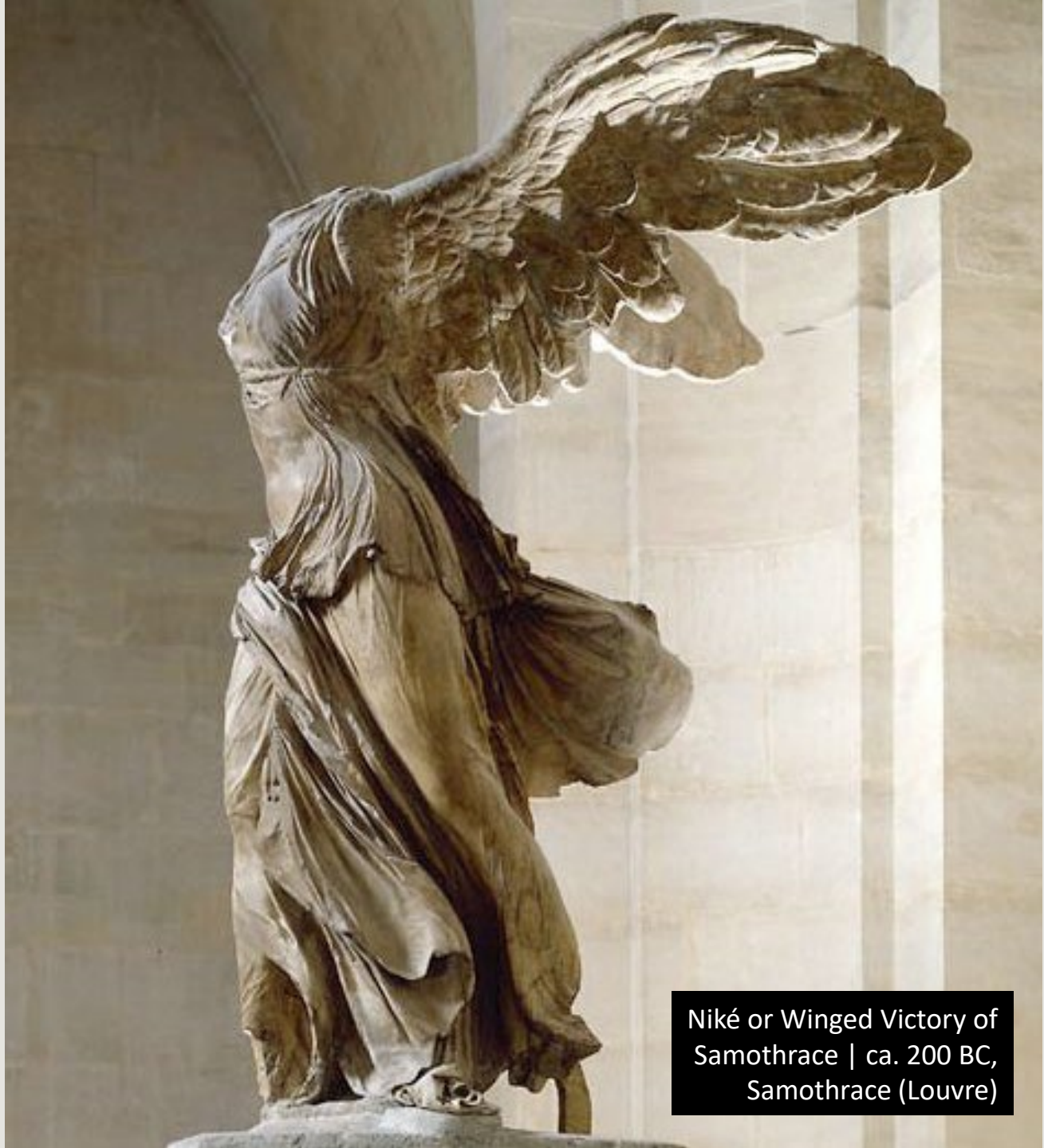
Hellenistic period

323 BC - 30 BC

End of Greek empire
& Ptolemaic Egypt
30 BC

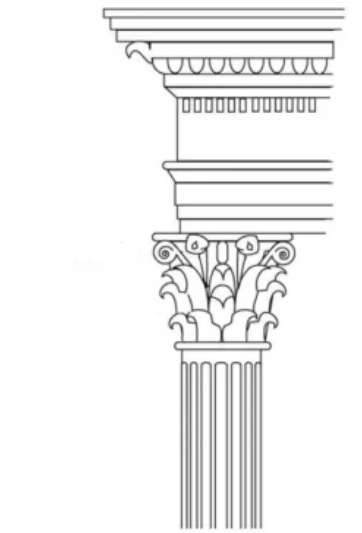
Hellenistic period

- Diversification
  influenced by new cultures
- More technical development
- More naturalism
- More expression / emotion
- Standardisation → lower quality

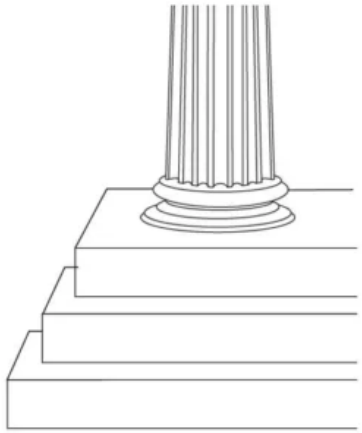


Niké or Winged Victory of Samothrace | ca. 200 BC, Samothrace (Louvre)

Left: Laocoön and His Sons | 200 BC - 70 (Vatican Museums)
Right: Venus de Milo | 2nd c. BC (Louvre)



Corinthian Order



Temple of Zeus | 6th c. BC – 2nd c., Athens

End of Greek empire & Ptolemaic Egypt
Conquest by the Romans
30 BC

Archaic Period
ca. 800 BC - 480 BC

Classical Period
448 BC - 323 BC

Hellenistic Period
323 BC - 30 BC

Roman Kingdom
753 BC - 509 BC

Roman Republic
509 BC - 27 BC

Roman Empire
27 BC - 476 AD

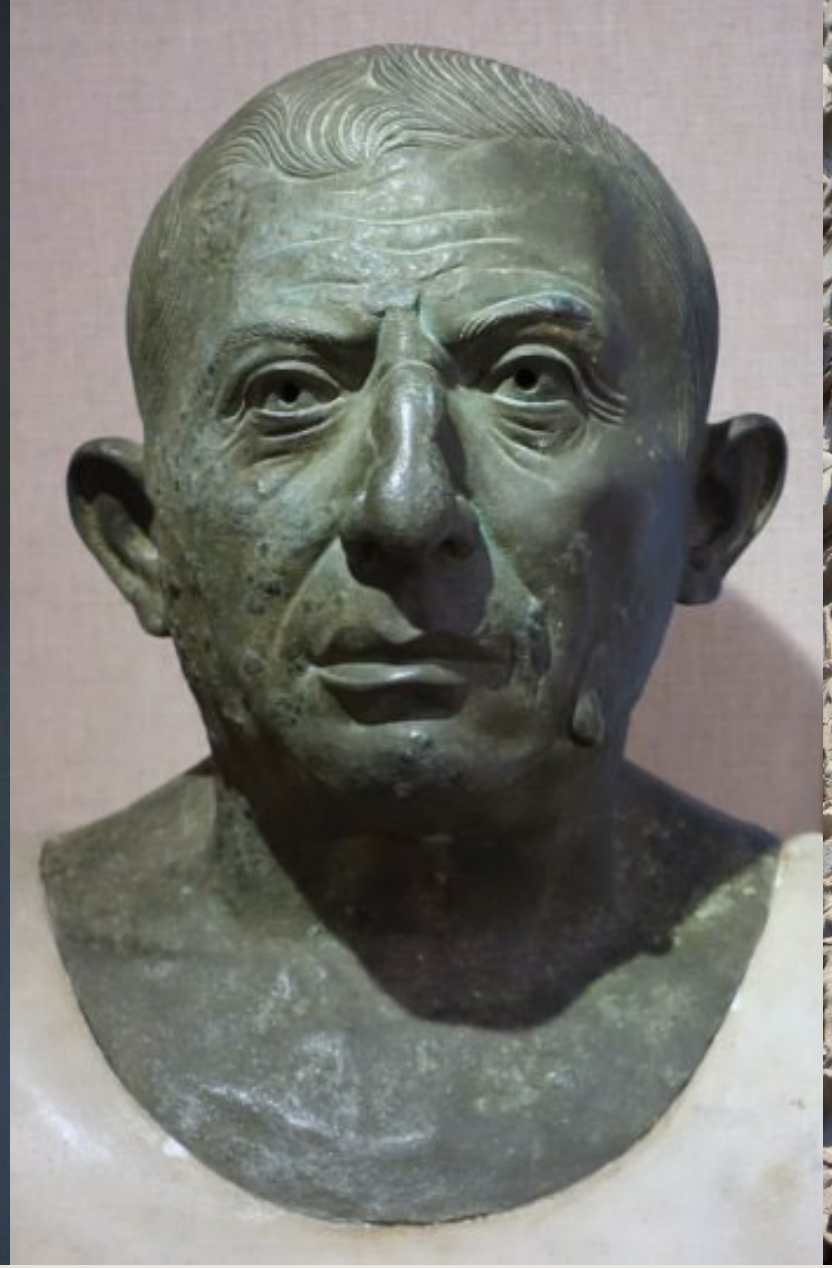
Christianity is state religion
in the Roman Empire
319

= when the artist fills every empty space

Roman empire

- Copying Greek sculptures
  + more bas reliefs
- Richness → Horror Vacui
- Vivid and more dynamic
- Realism in depiction and subject

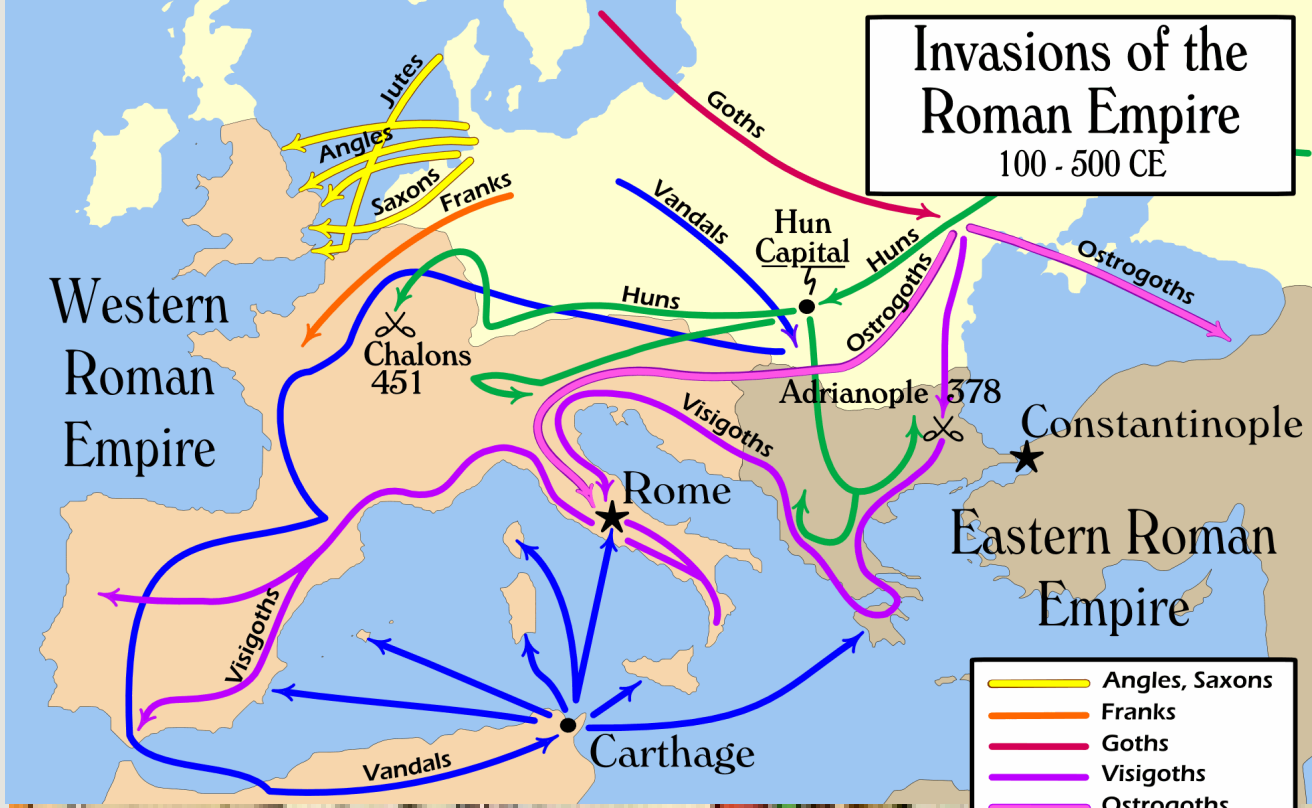
Portonaccio-sarcofaag| ca. 180, Rome (Museo Nazionale Romano)



Left: Augustus of Prima Porta | 1st c., Rome (Vatican Museums)
Middle: bust of Jucundus | ca. 50, Pompeii (Spurlock Museum) // Right: detail Trajan's column | 113 ,Rome

The fall of a great empire in 476:

- East → Byzantian Empire
- West → Holy Roman Empire
  and the “Dark Ages”



“Craddle of European civilization”

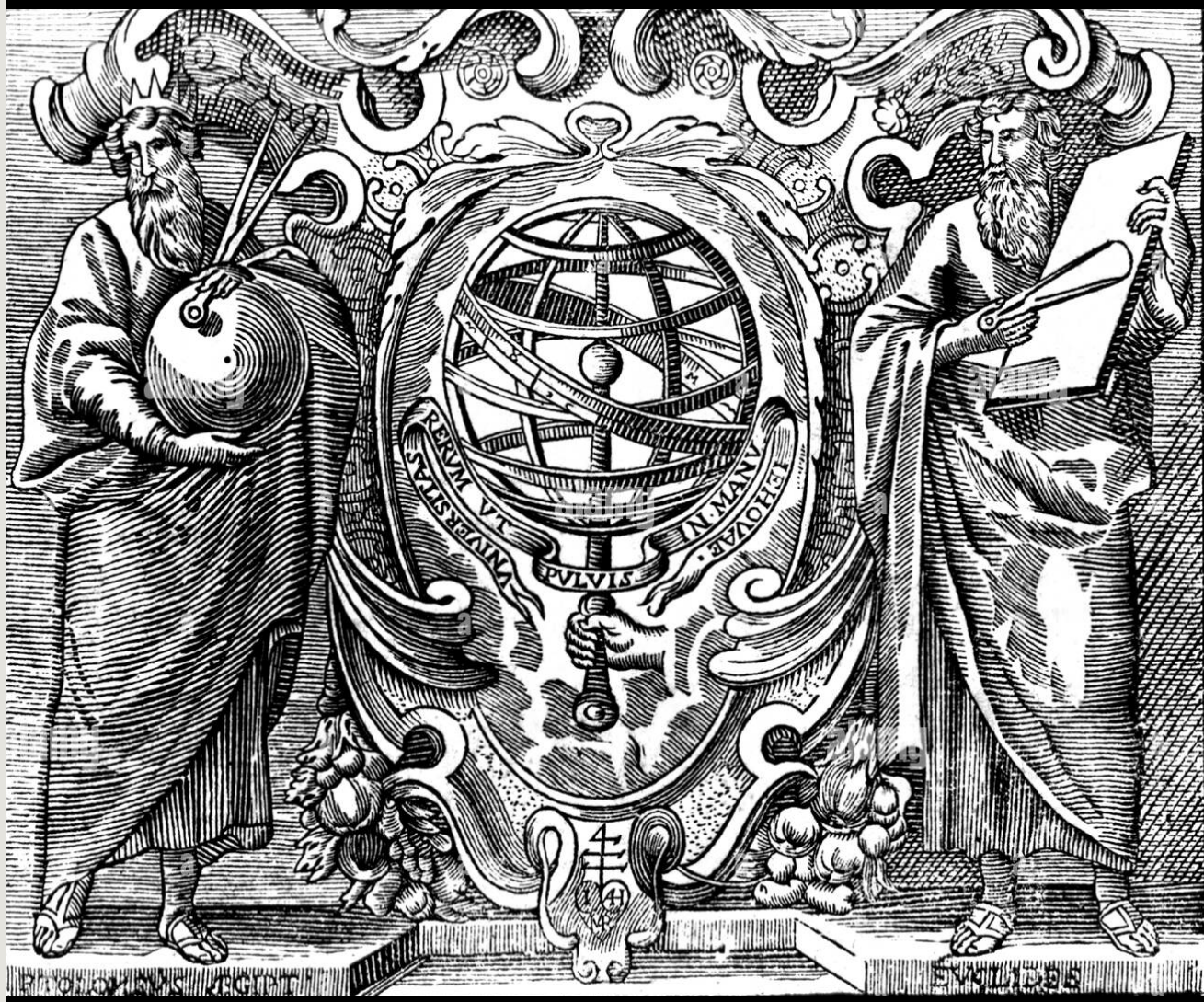
- Political structures
  - Kingdom
  - Democracy
  - Empire

Engraving of the Etruscan bronze | Antonio Lafreri | 1552, Rome (MMoA, NY)

Cicero Denounces Catiline | Cesare Maccari | 1889, Palazzo Madama (Rome)

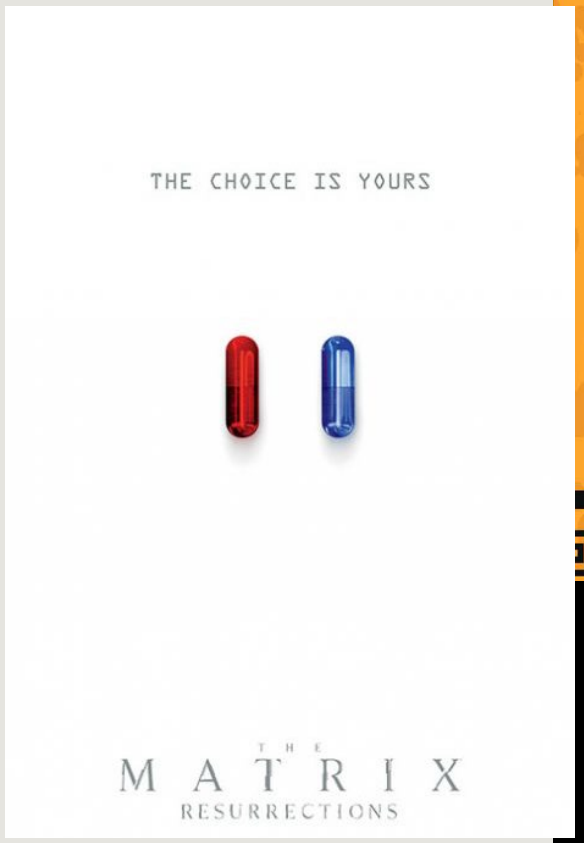
“Craddle of European civilization”

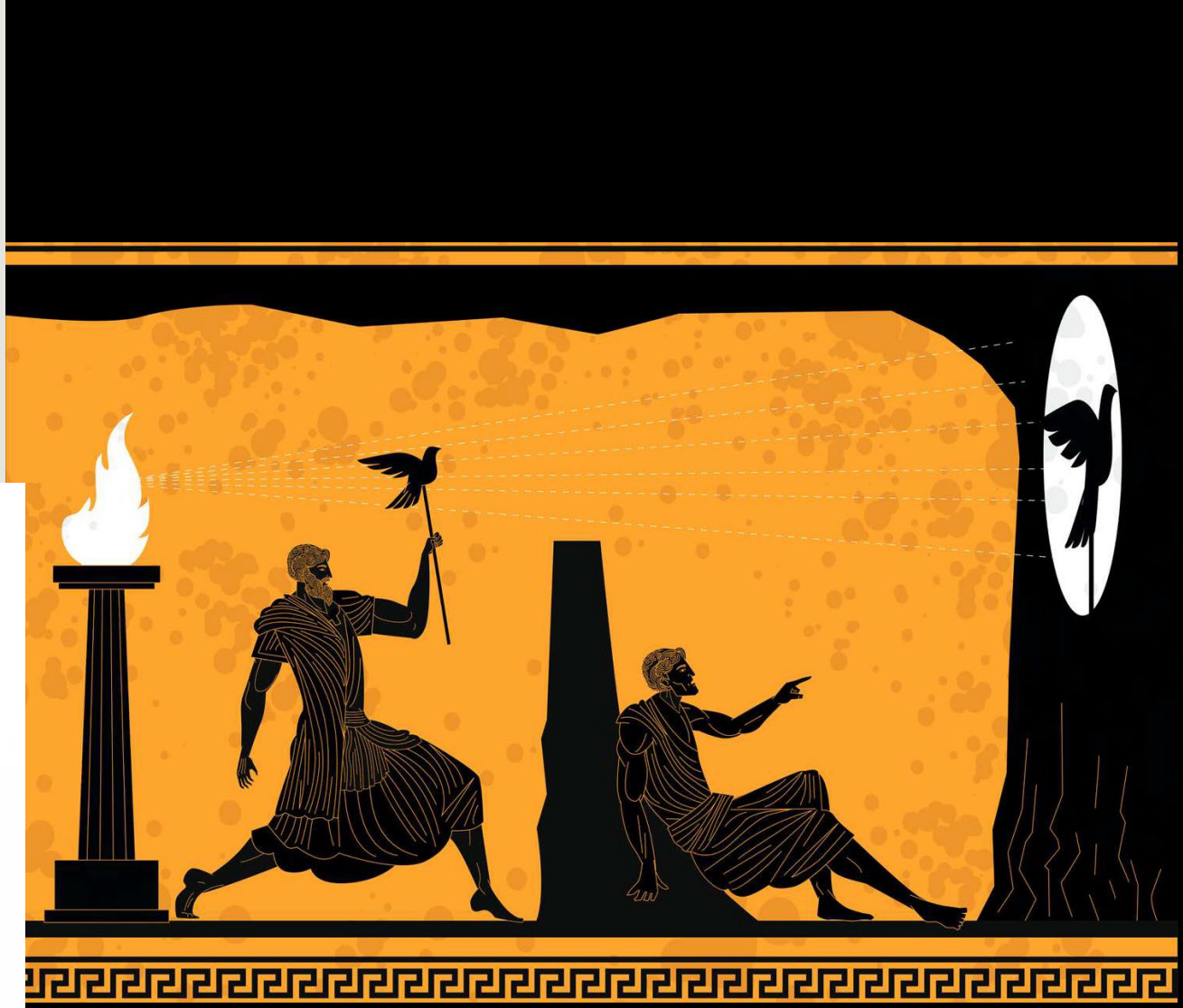
- Political structures
- Science



“Craddle of European civilization”

- Political structures
- Science
- Philosophy

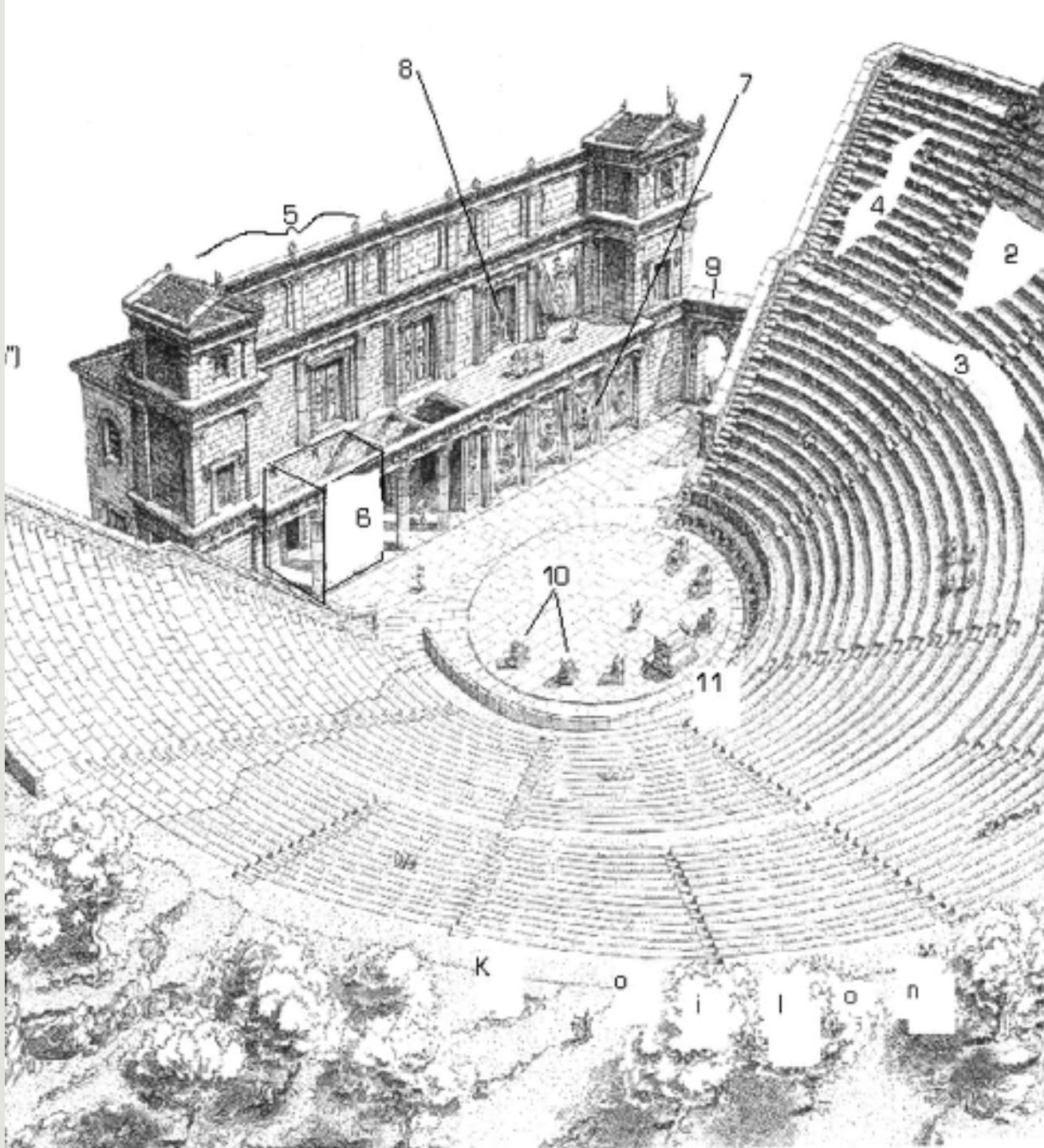




Allegory of the Cave | Plato

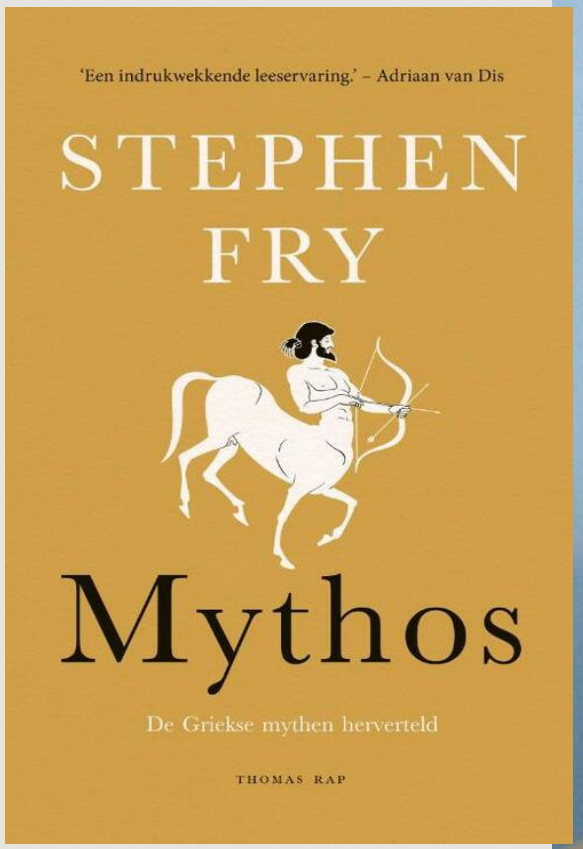
“Craddle of European civilization”

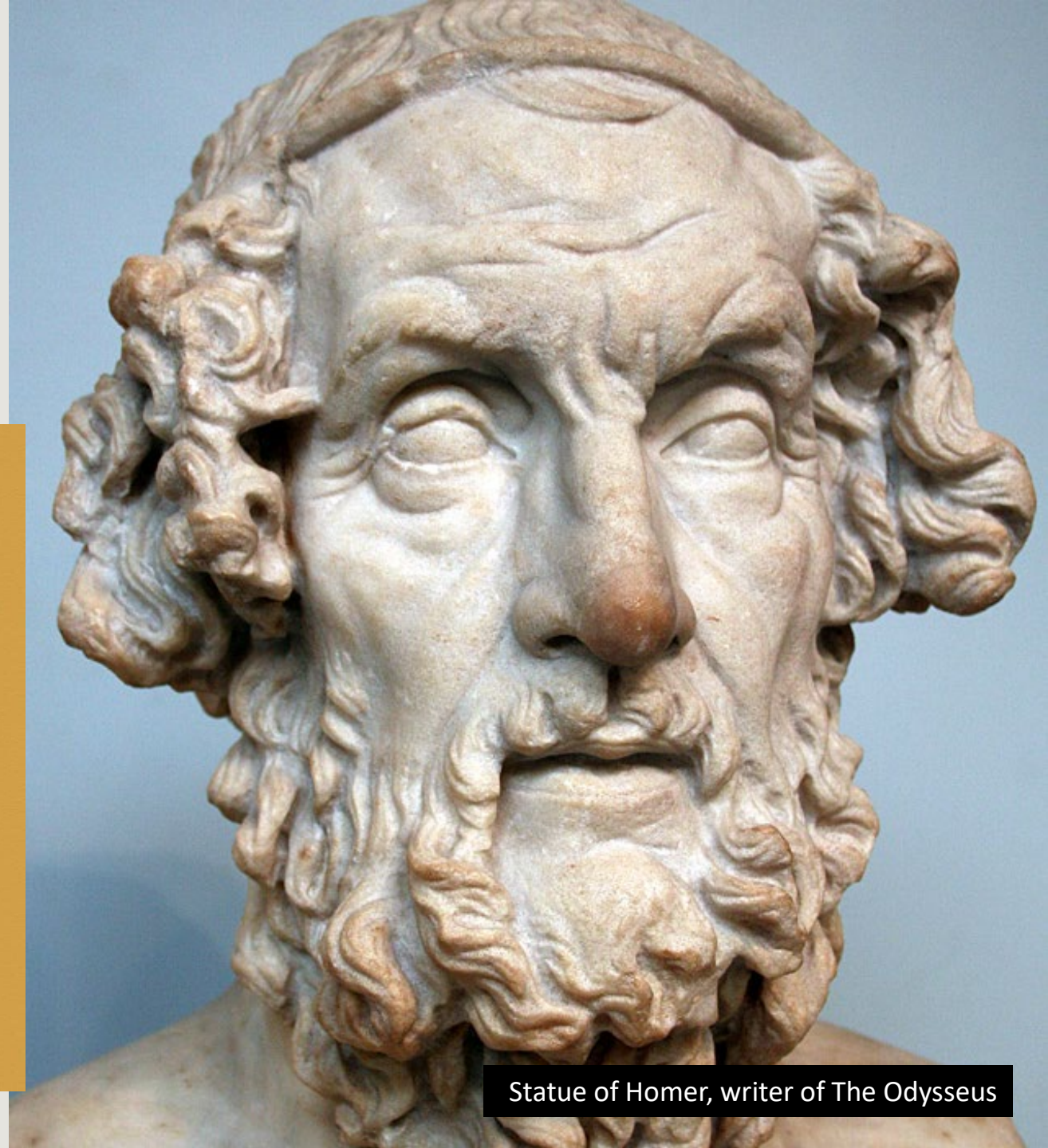
- Political structures
- Science
- Philosophy
- Theatre
  - Comedy & tragedy
  - Story structure
  - Trilogies
  - Deus ex machina
  - …



“Craddle of European civilization”

- Political structures
- Science
- Philosophy
- Theatre
- Literature





Statue of Homer, writer of The Odysseus

“Craddle of European civilization”

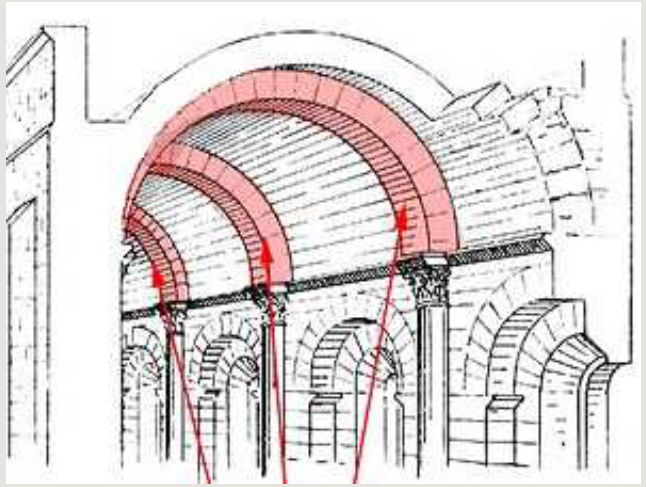
- Political structures
- Science
- Philosophy
- Theatre
- Literature
- Architecture

Colosseum | 72 - 80, Rome

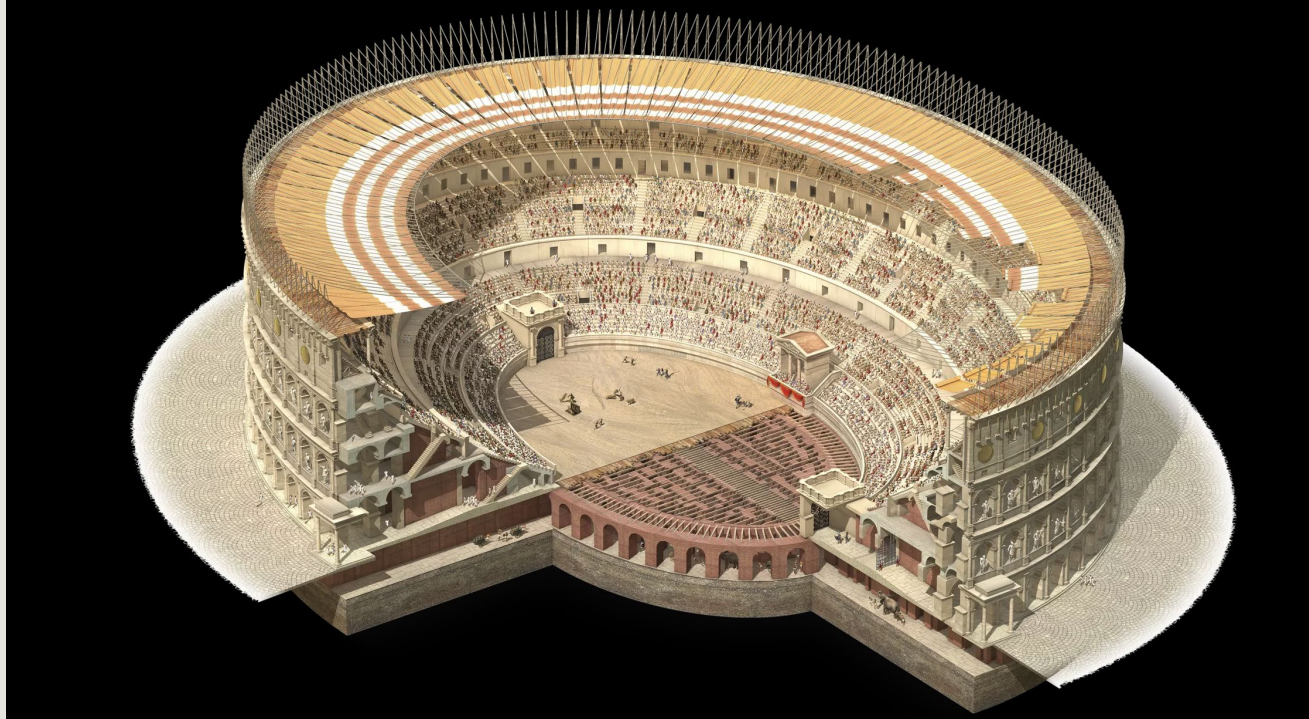
Advanced technology and construction methods:

- Round arches and barrel vaults
- Pillars as decoration

perfected



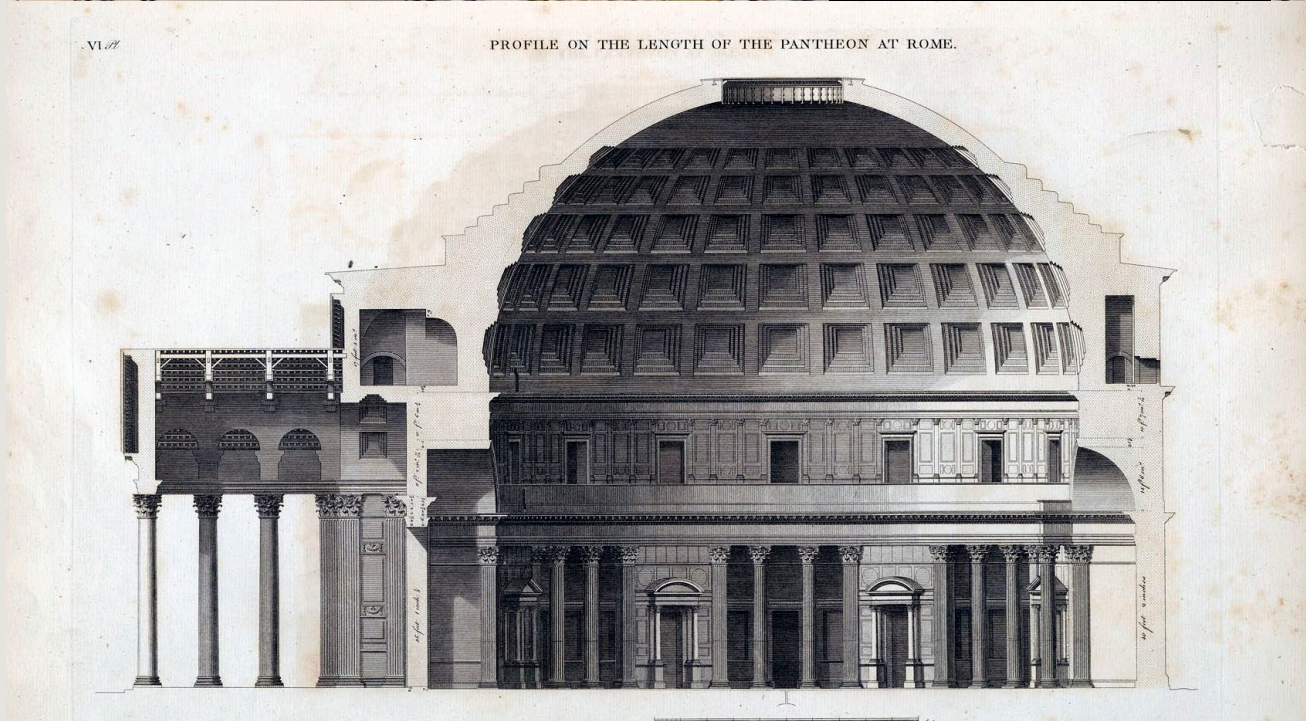
Colosseum | 72 - 80, Rome



Advanced technology and construction methods:

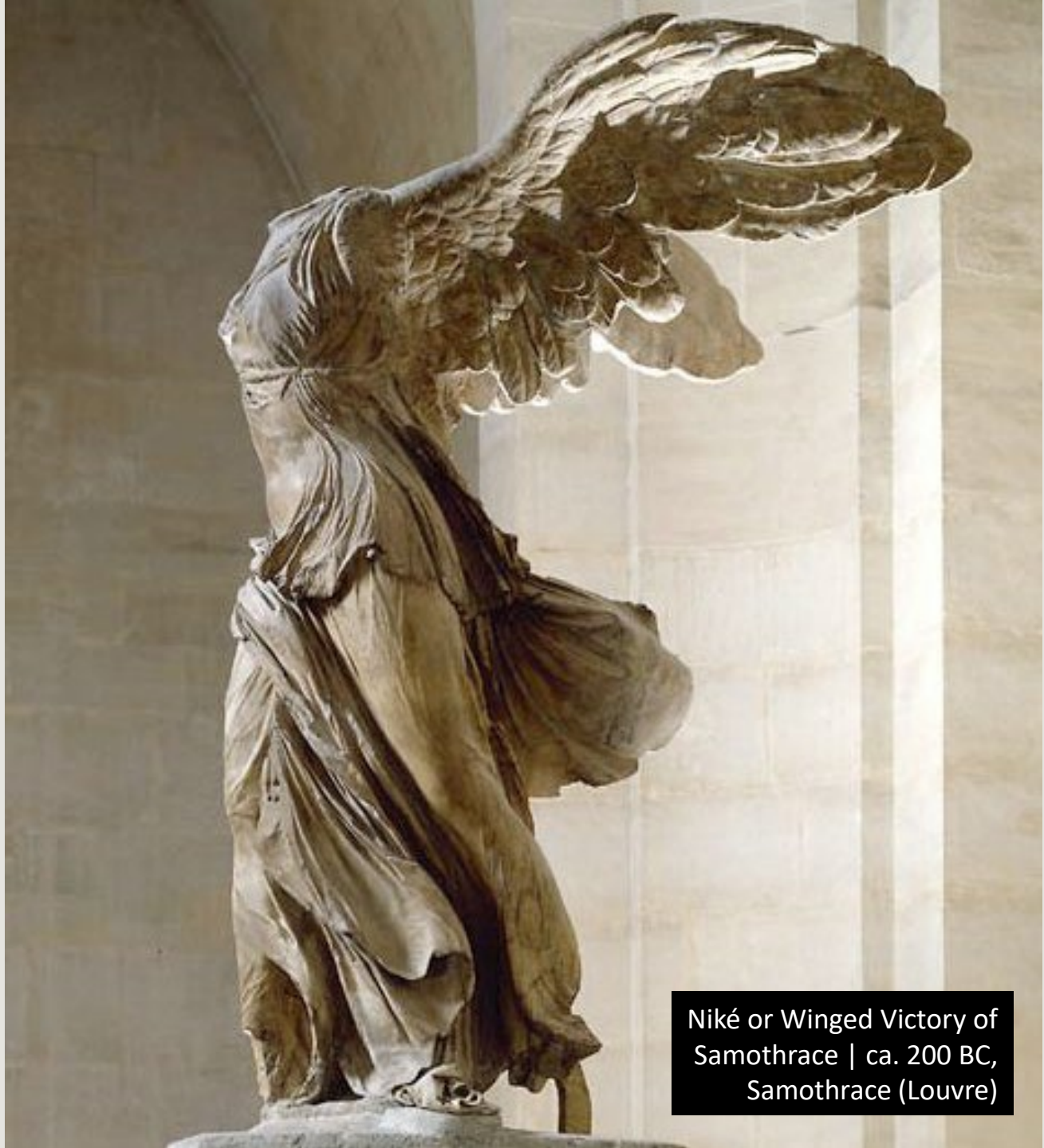
- Round arches and barrel vaults
- Pillars as decoration
- Domes
- Concrete

Pantheon | ca. 126, Rome



“Craddle of European civilization”

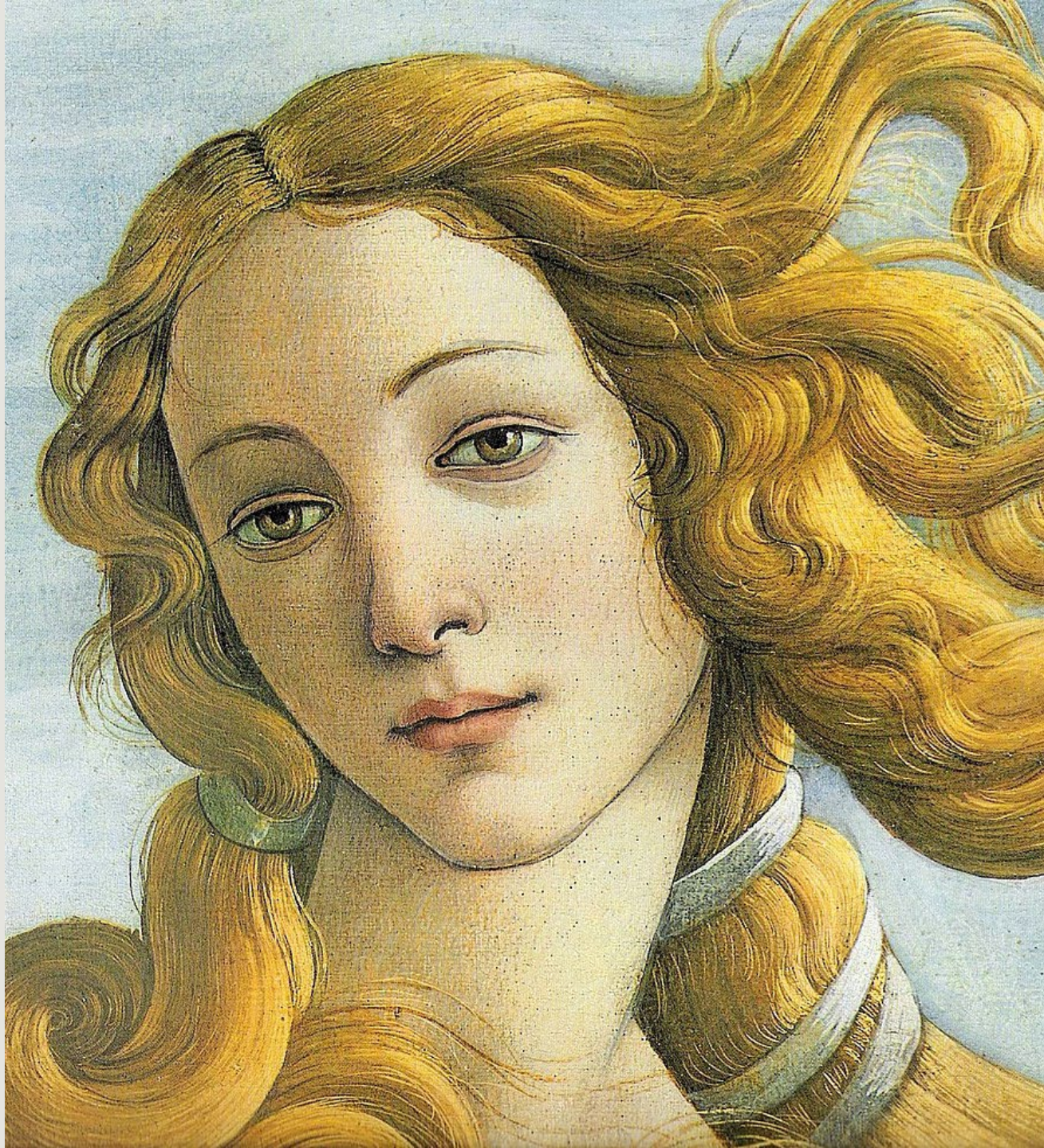
- Political structures
- Science
- Philosophy
- Theatre
- Literature
- Architecture
- Visual arts

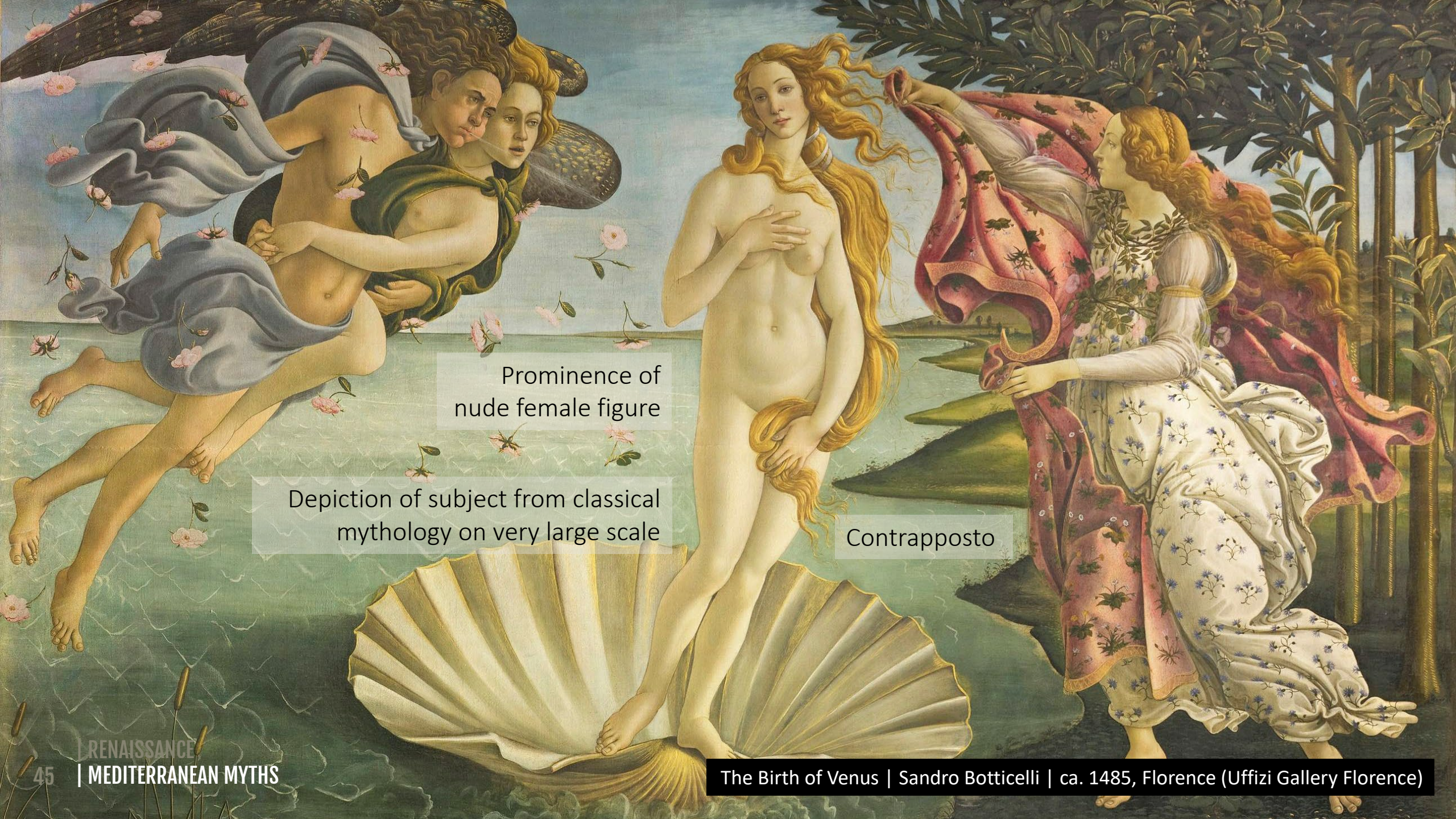


Niké or Winged Victory of Samothrace | ca. 200 BC, Samothrace (Louvre)

3 | RENAISSANCE

CA. 1300 – 1600, ITALY

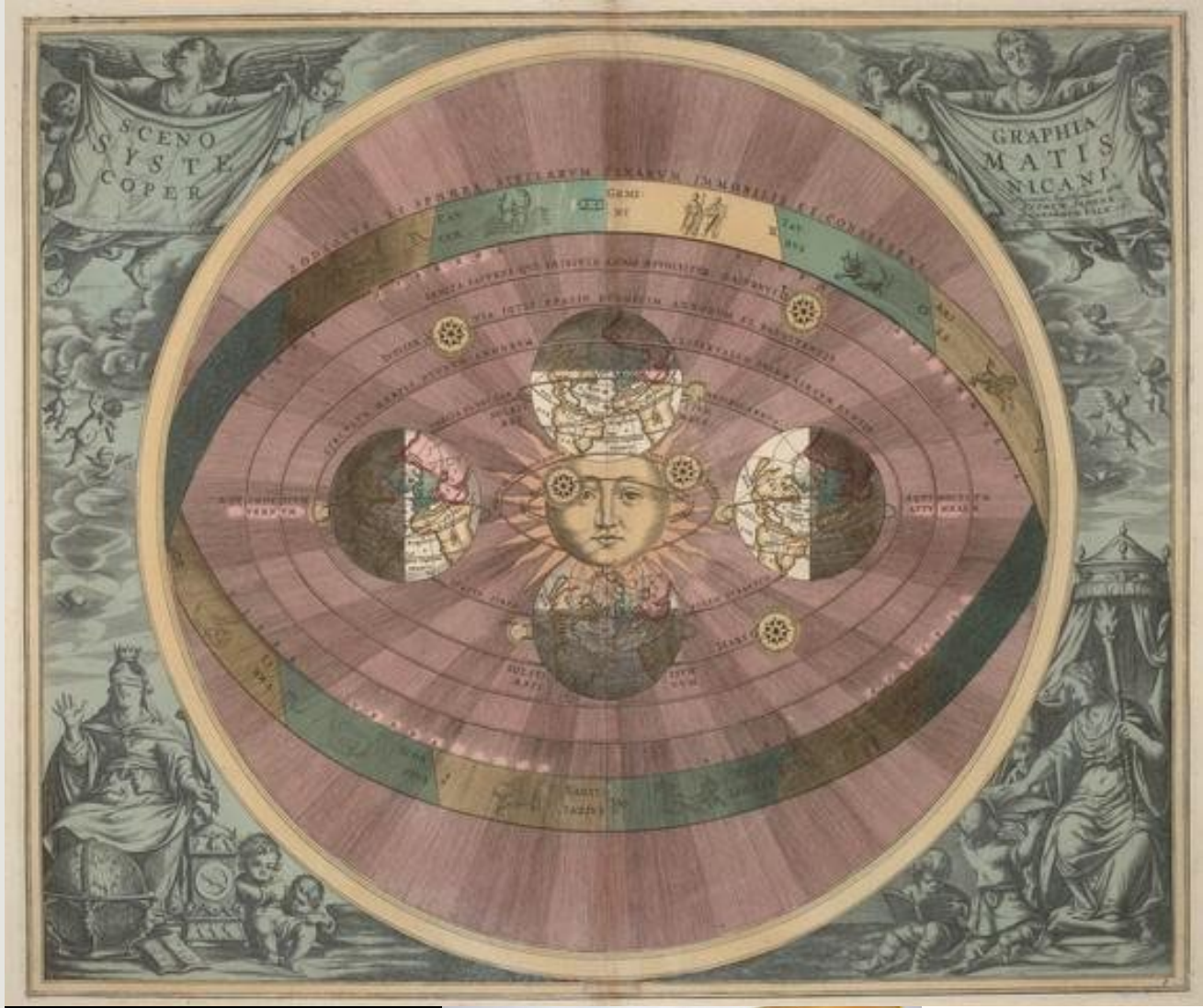


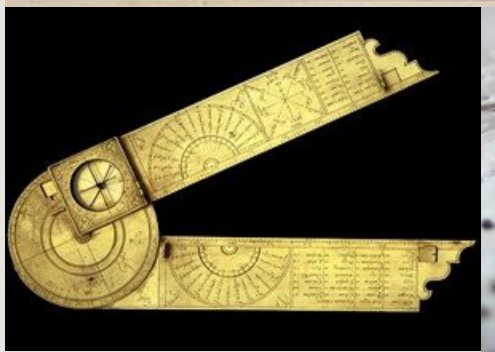


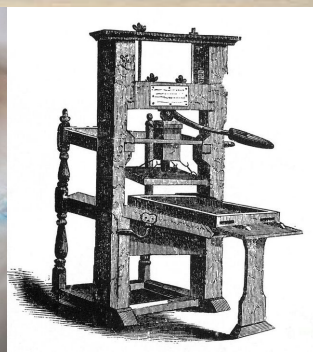
The Birth of Venus | Sandro Botticelli | ca. 1485, Florence (Uffizi Gallery Florence)

Renaissance

- Starting in Italy, ca. 1300 – 1600
- Rebirth of European culture
  Humanism and study of classic arts
- Major changes:
  - End of feudal system / Secularism
  - Cities in Flanders, Italian city-states,..
  - Discovery of new continents
    like Colombus in 1492
  - Heliocentrism
  - New technologies
    compass, gunpowder, paper, printing,…



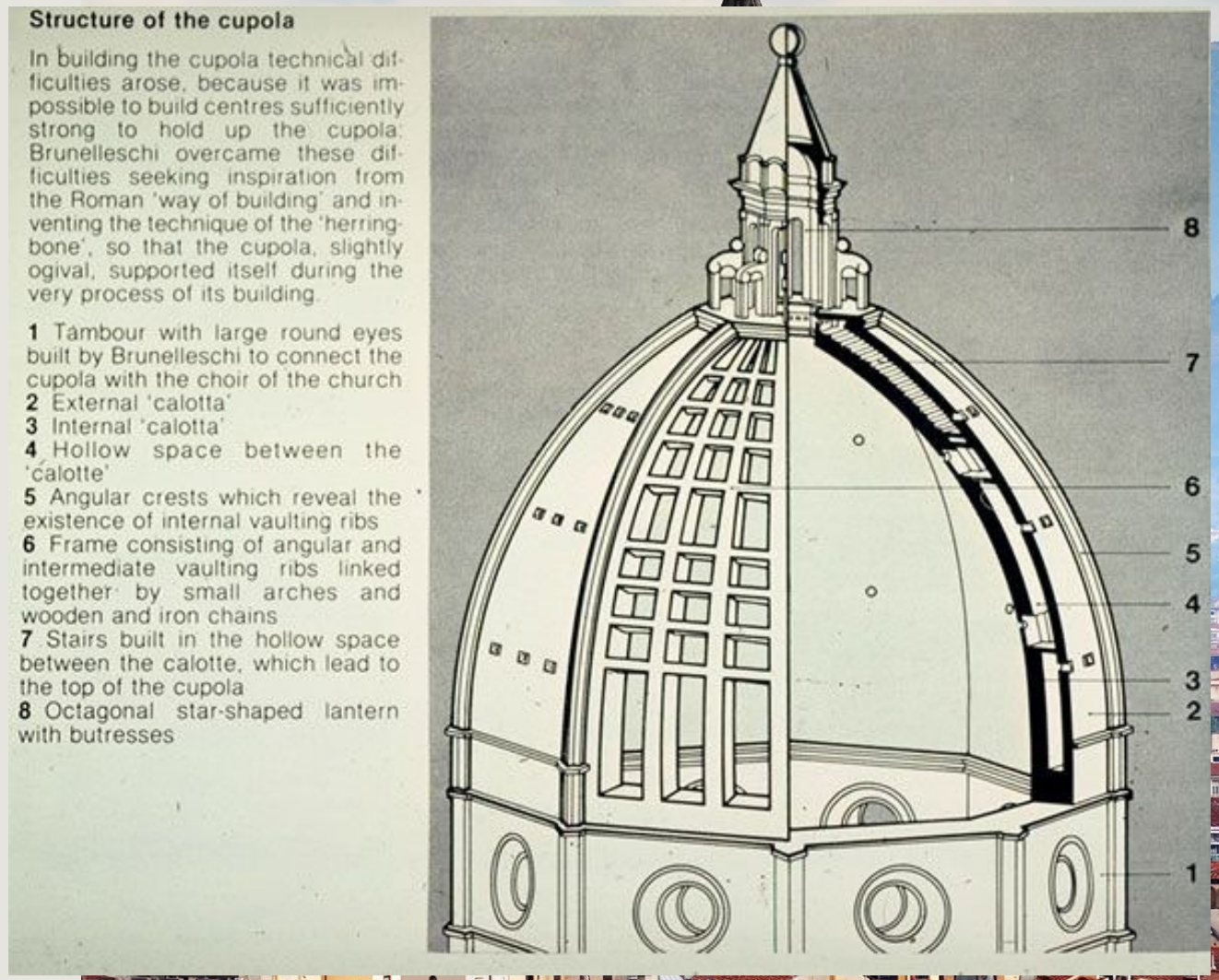




Duomo of Florence | Filippo Brunelleschi | 1436, Florence

Duomo of Florence (1436)
by Filippo Brunelleschi

- Start of the Italian Renaissance
  - A break with Medieval Gothic style, no longer using flying butresses
  - Return to classic Mediterranean dome, like dome of the Pantheon
- Largest ever built in western Europe at the time



Baptisterium in front of the duomo of Florence

… named by Michelangelo

Gates of Paradise

Lorenzo Ghiberti and pupils | 1425 - 1452, Florence (Museo dell'Opera del Duomo)

- Events of Old Testament
- Naturalistic
- Greater idealization of subject
- Use of recently discovered principles of perspective

David | Michelangelo | 1501 - 1504, Florence
(Galleria dell'Accademia, Florence)

David

- First colossal marble statue made in early modern period
- Renaissance interpretation of the Greek heroic male nude
- Depicted before the battle
  instead of after battle, with Goliath's head
- Perfect anatomy
  but slightly bigger head and hands
- Contrapposto

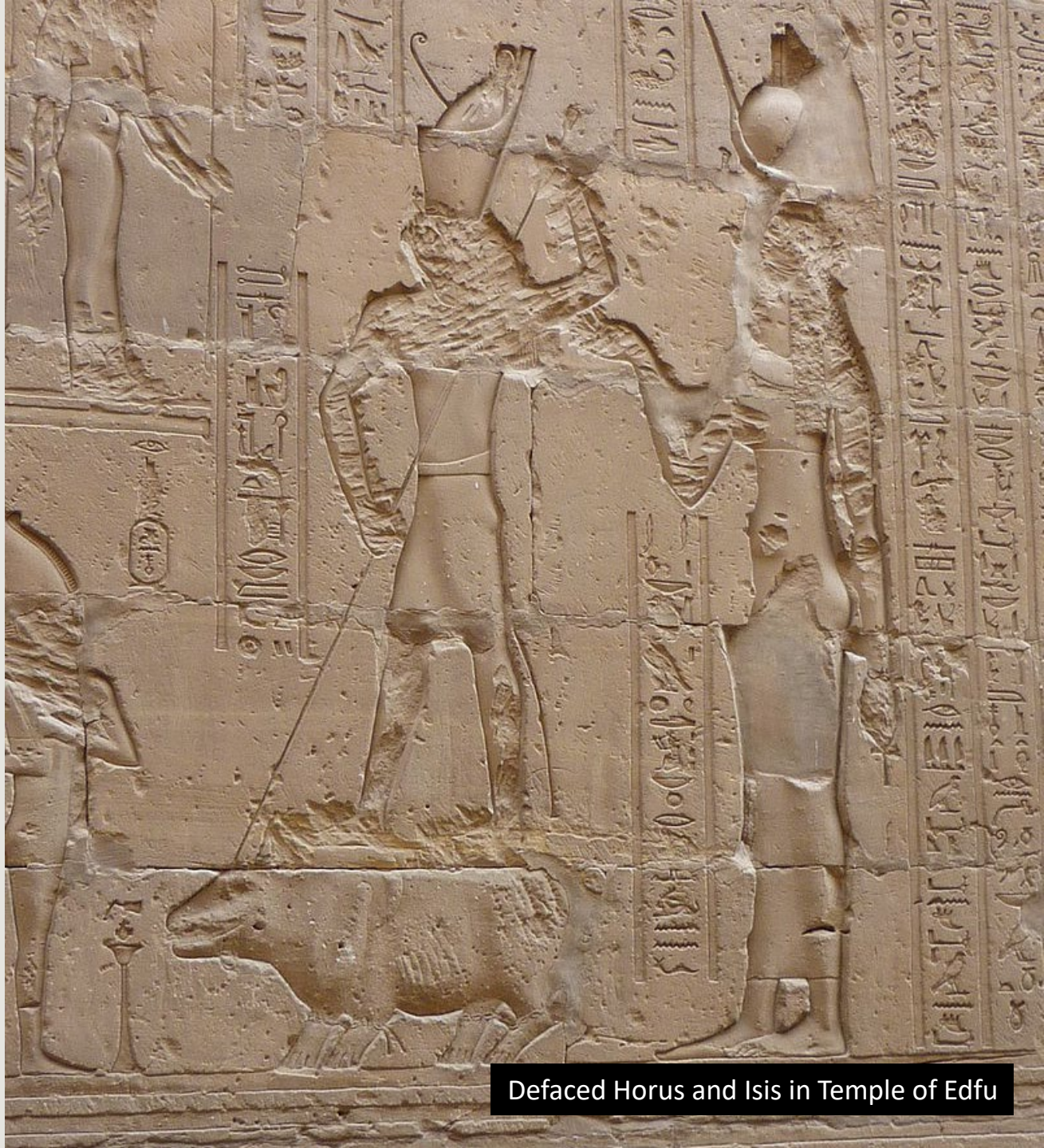
DESTRUCTION

Art destruction

- Willful, accidental or natural decay or material deconstruction of a work of art

Iconoclasm

- The social belief in the importance of the destruction of icons, images or monuments, for religious or political reasons



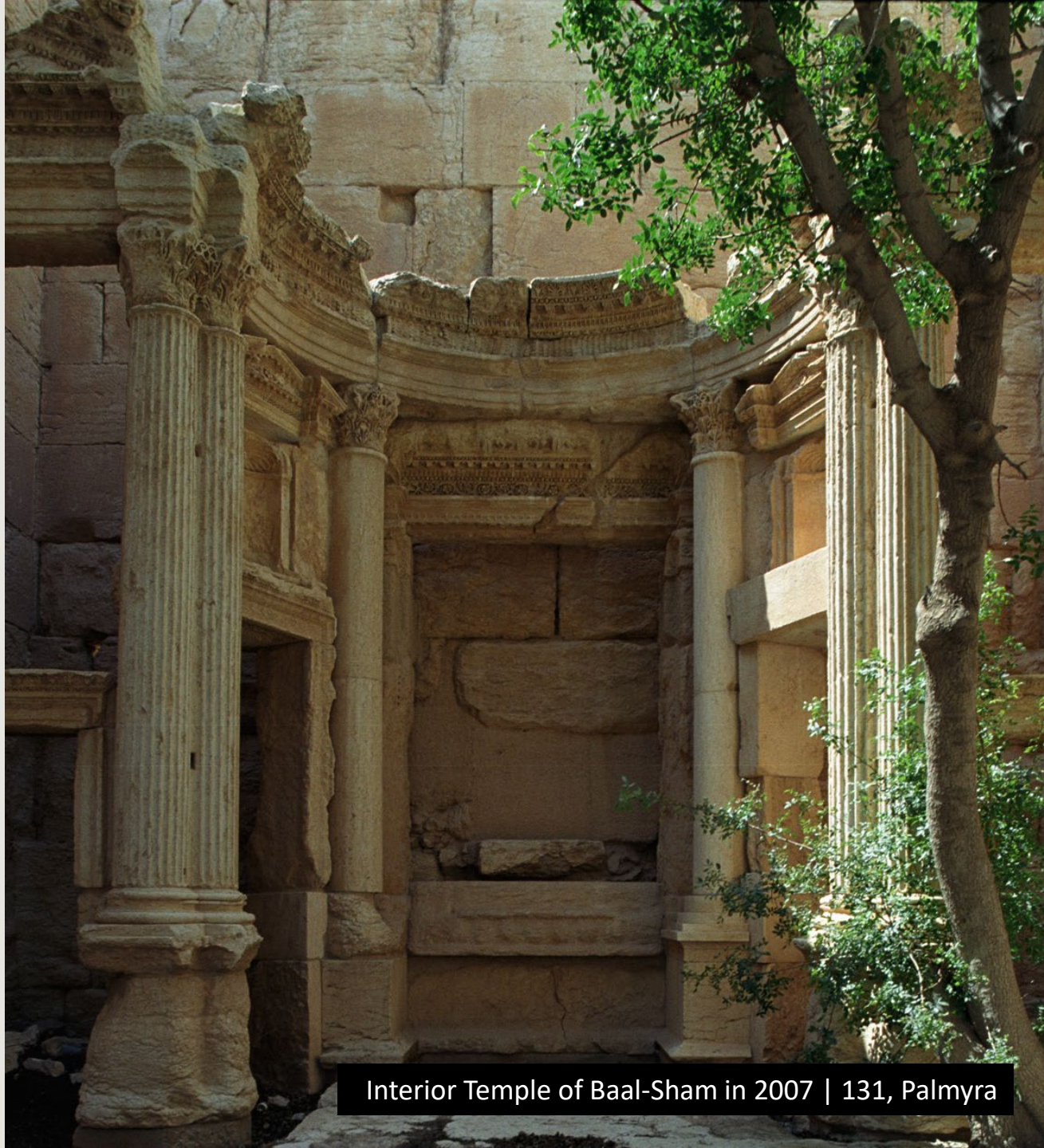
Defaced Horus and Isis in Temple of Edfu

1 | ICONOCLASM IN PALMYRA

2015 – 2017 | SYRIA

Palmyra

- Wealth from trade caravans
- Roman, Hellenistic and other Mediterranean influences
  - Political organization
  - Switching between religion, language, etc.
  - Monumental building projects
- Archeological site
  on the World Heritage List

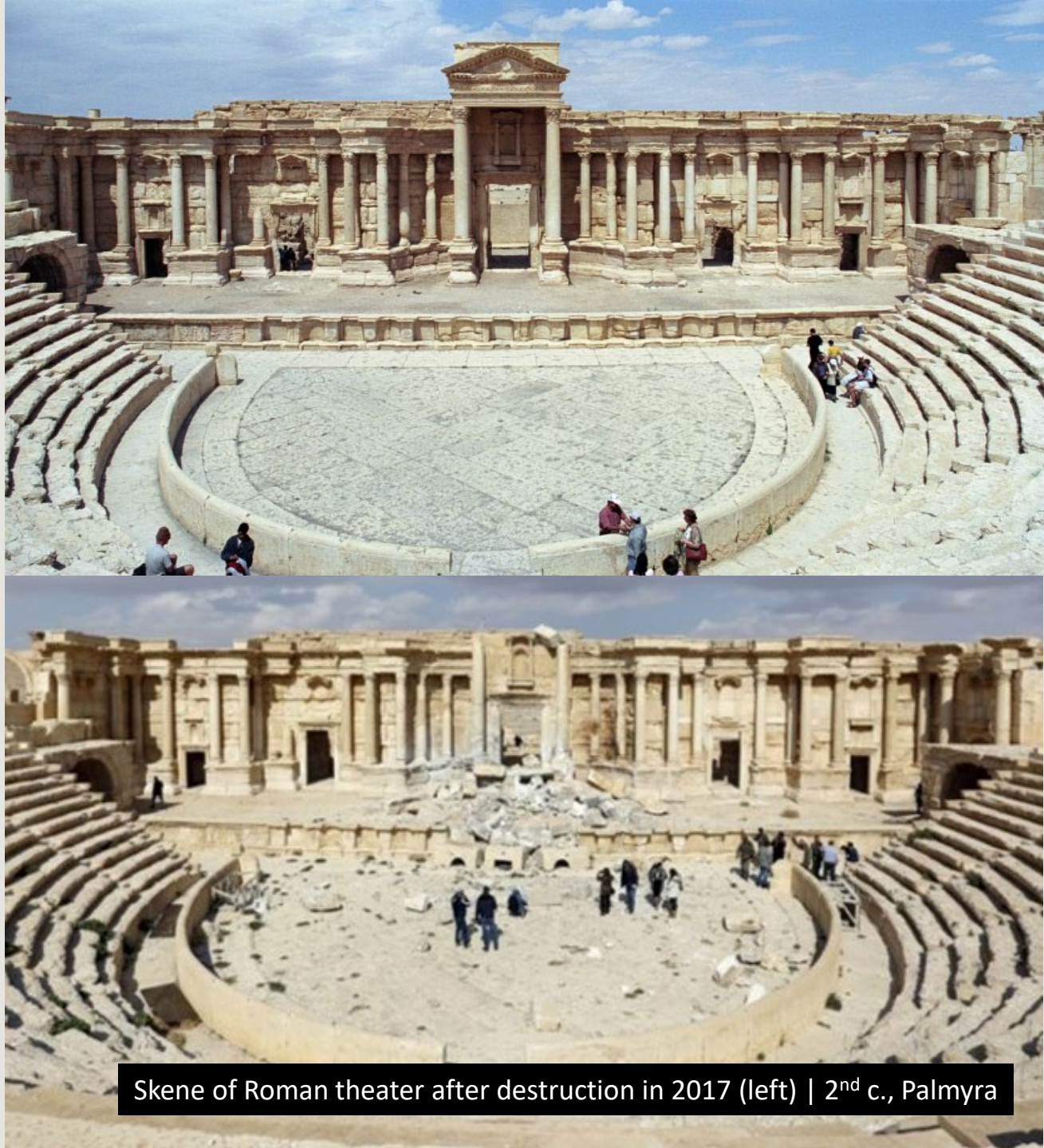


Interior Temple of Baal-Sham in 2007 | 131, Palmyra

Remains of the Temple of Baal-Sham after destruction in 2015 | 131, Palmyra

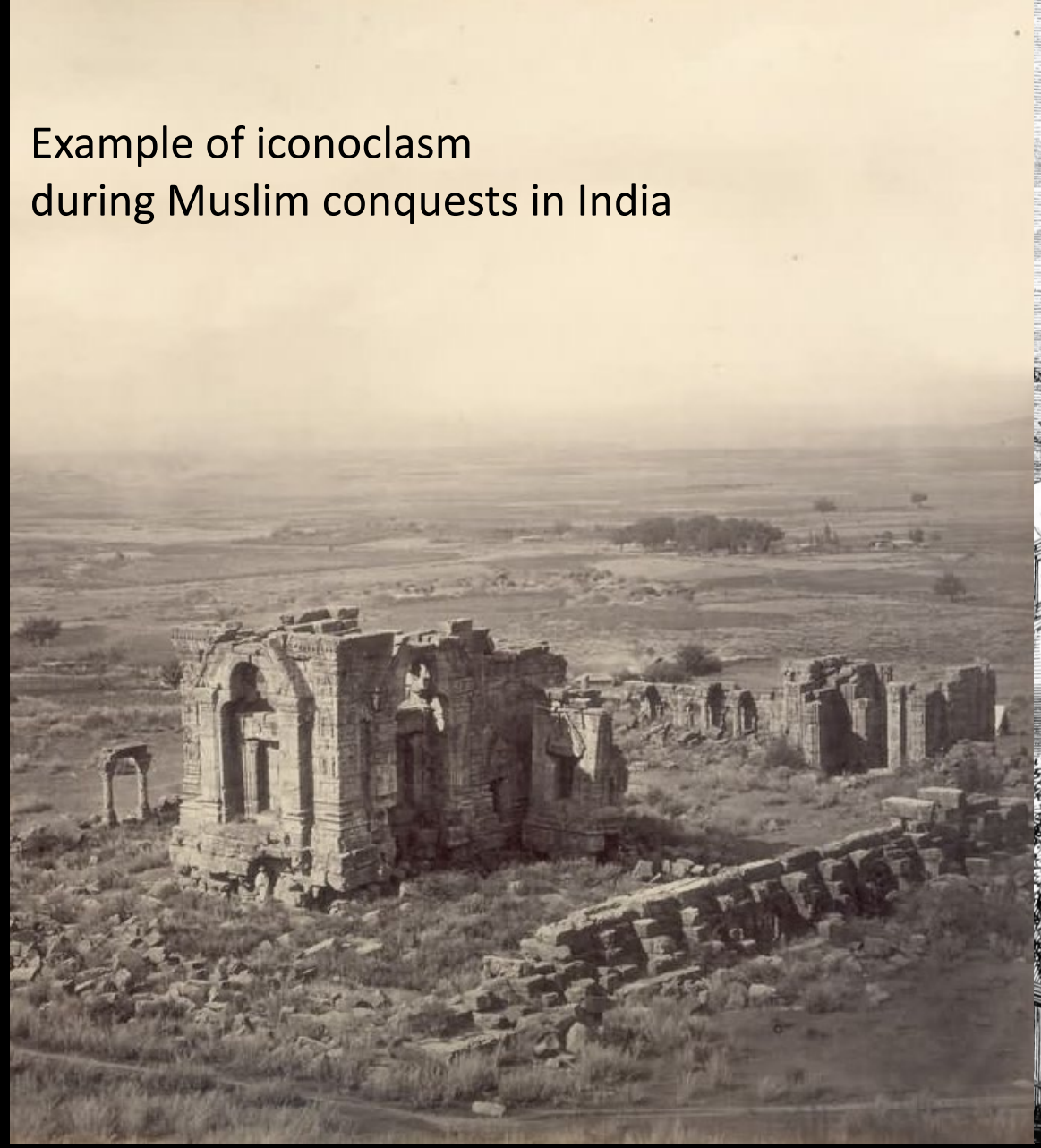
Skene of the Roman theatre | 2nd c., Palmyra

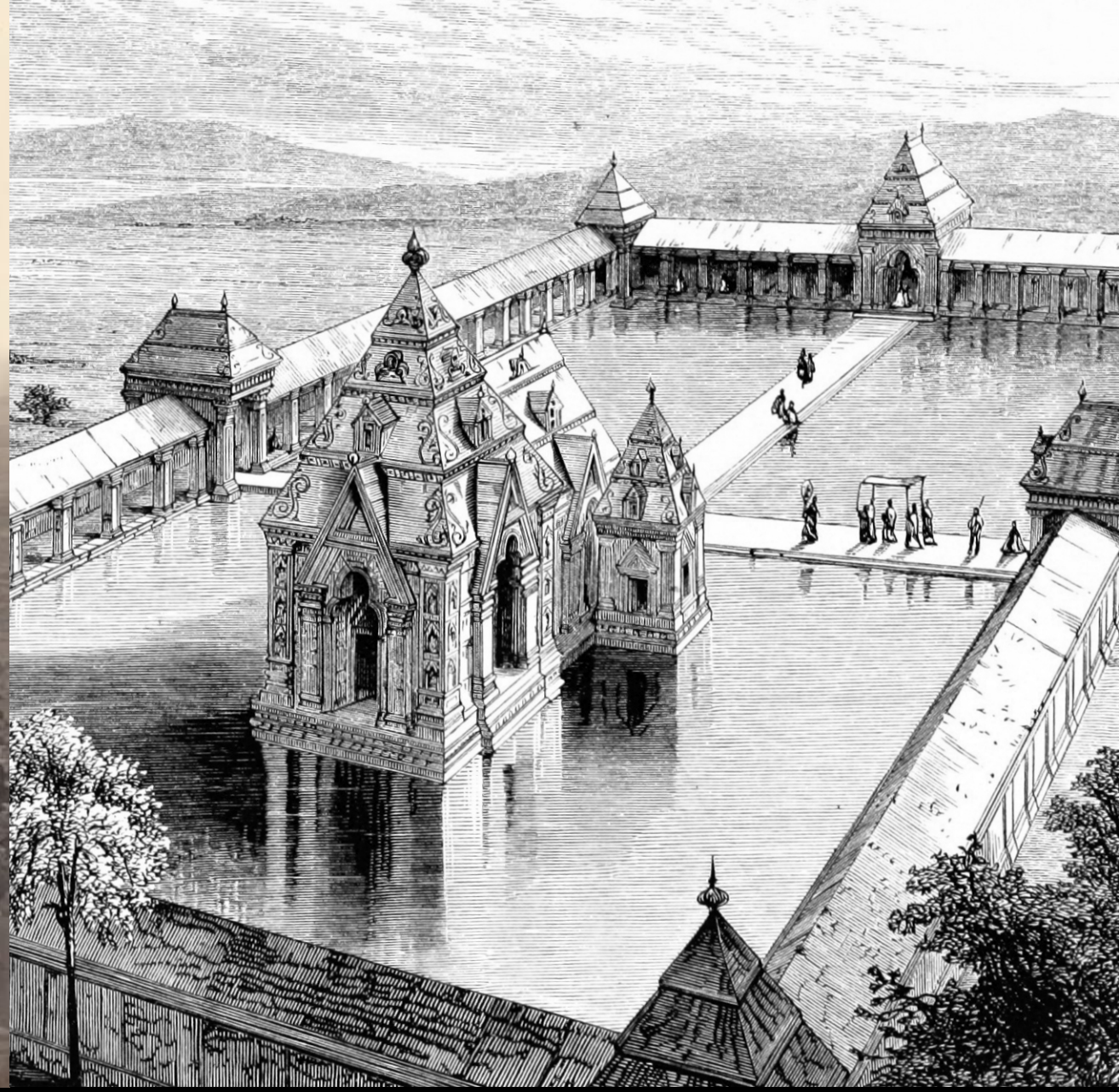
- 2011: Syrian Civil War
- 2013: Damage due to bombing
- 2015: Islamic State of Iraq and the Levant captures Palmyra
- 2017: Retaken by Syrian government
- 2023: Start restoration of theatre



Skene of Roman theater after destruction in 2017 (left) | 2nd c., Palmyra

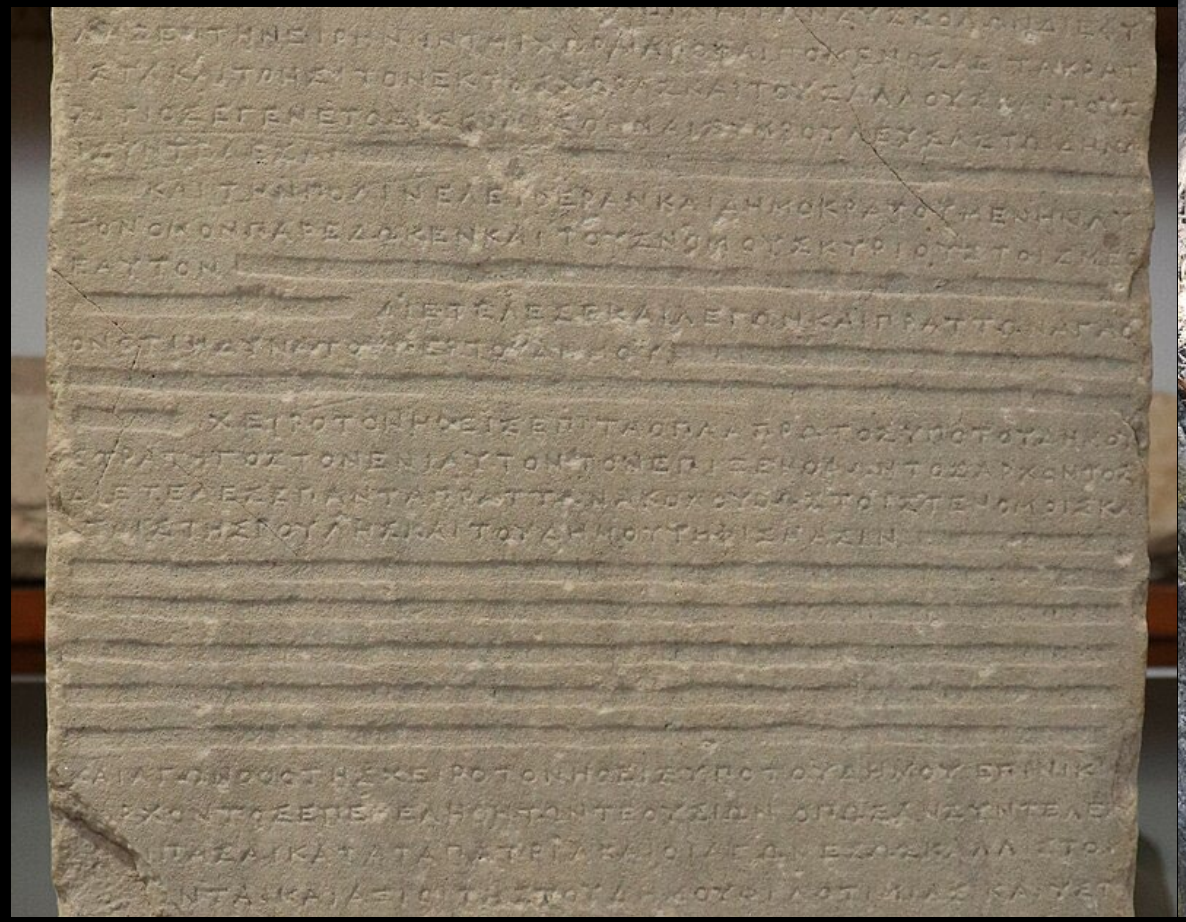
Example of iconoclasm
during Muslim conquests in India





Left: temple after destruction by sultan Sikandar Shah Miri (early 15th c.) and multiple earthquakes
Right: impression Martand Sun Temple (8th c., Anantnag)| J. Duguid | 1870

Examples of political iconoclasm
by deliberate destruction of depictions,
inscriptions, documents, etc.



Left: Chisseled lines in honorific decree for Phaedrus of Sphettus (ca.259 BC.) erasing interactions with Antigonids (ca. 200 BC.)
Right: Chapultepec portrait of Mexican monarch Moctezuma II (1519), intentionally damaged in middle of 18th c.

Left: Remains of Stalin statue after Hungary's October Revolution (1956, Budapest)
Right: Saddam Hussein's statue toppling over (2003, Firdos Square Baghdad)

Left : Christopher Columbus in St Paul Minnesota (2020)
Right : Slave trader Edward Colston in Bristol

Art Vandalism by Just Stop Oil

2 | QUESTIONABLE OWNERSHIP
OF THE ELGIN MARBLES

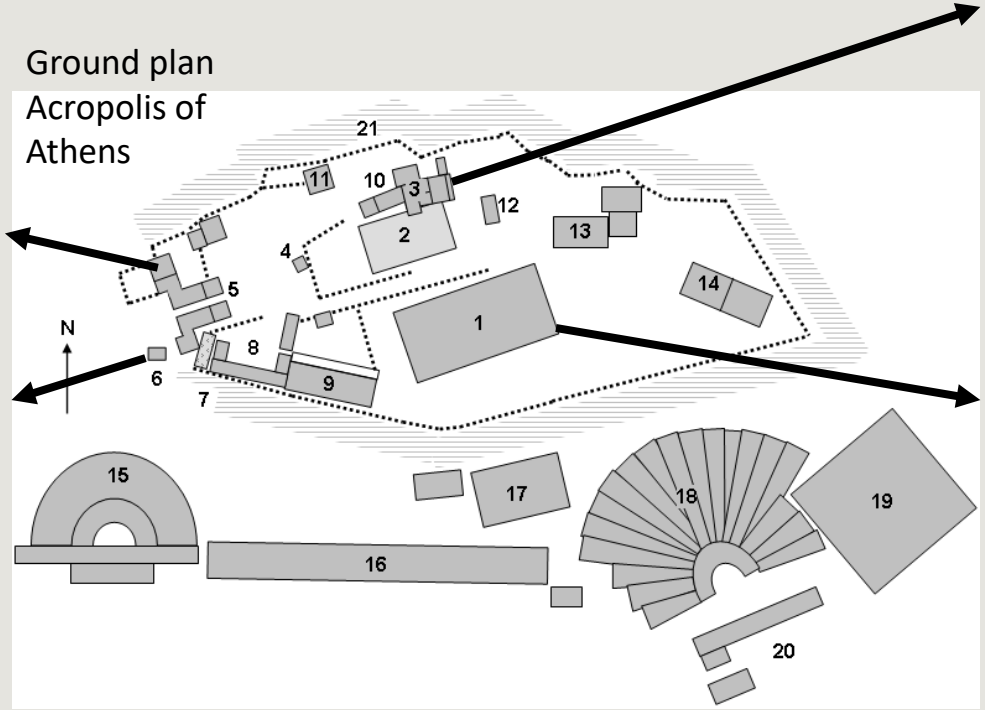
Acropolis of Athens

akron = "highest point“ | polis = "city"

- Inhabited since 4th millenium BC
- Most of the important buildings were constructed during the Golden Age of Athens (460 - 430 BC)

Propylaia | 437 - 432 BC

Ground plan
Acropolis of
Athens



Erechtheion or Temple of Athena Polias
| 421 - 406 BC

Temple of Athena Nike | ca. 420 BC

Parthenon| 447 - 432 BC

Parthenon

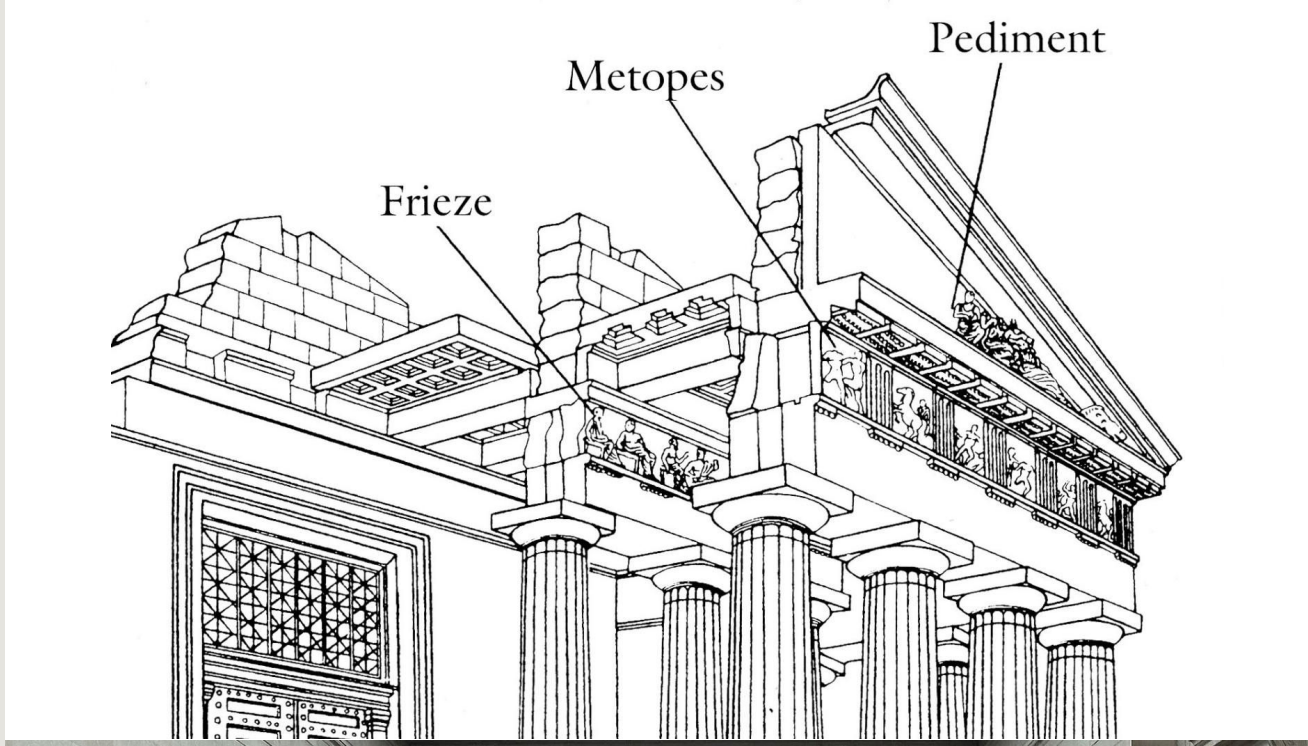
- Build as thanks giving for victory during Greco-Persian War
  under direction of sculptor Phidias
- Converted to Christian church
- Mosque after Ottoman conquest
- Venetian bomb damages the temple used as munition dump
- 1800: sculptures taken by Lord Thomas Bruce, 7th Earl of Elgin
  with permission of Ottoman government

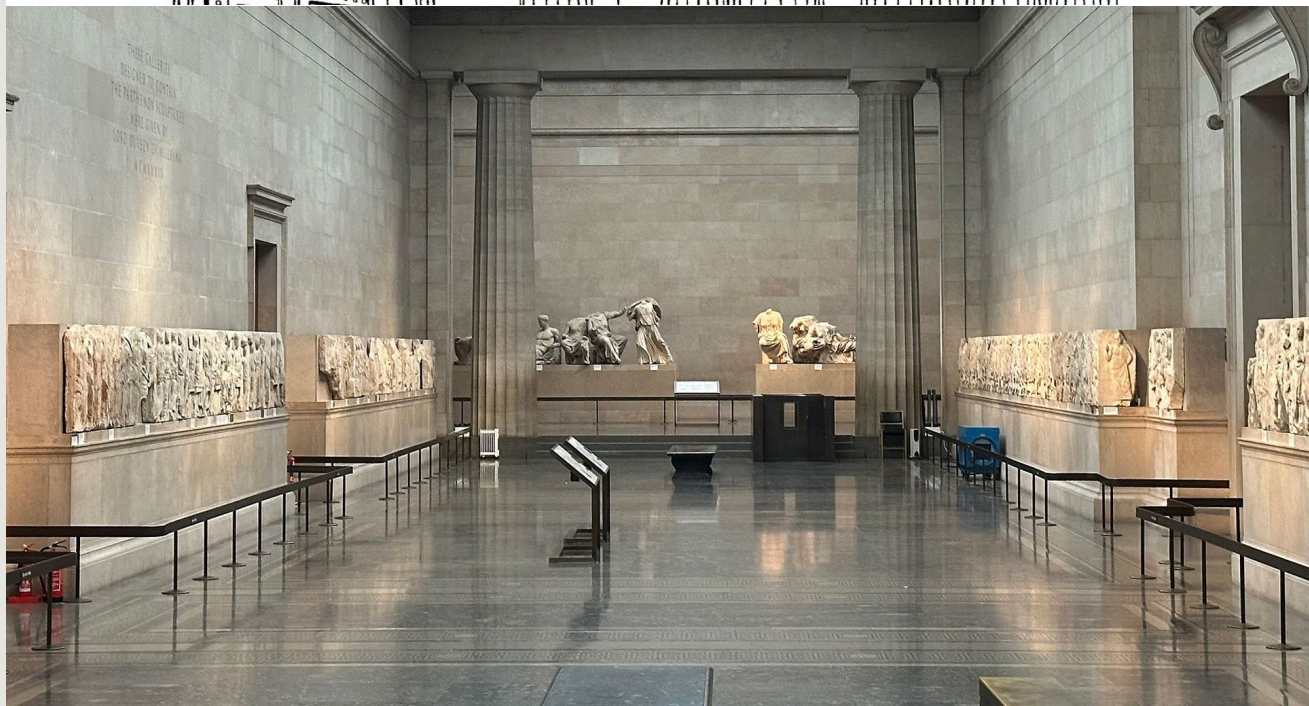
sculptures Parthenon | Phidias | ca. 447 - 438 BC

Elgin or Parthenon Marbles

Sculptures from frieze, metopes, and pediments

- Transported to England for private museum / use
- 1816: Sold to the British government due to financial problems
  - State property because of their exeptional cultural value
  - Specially designed rooms in British Museum
- Since 1990: dispute between British and Greek governments





Podcast tip: Stuff the British stole - Losing your Marbles:
https://open.spotify.com/episode/3FCyz6uluJzmXpPwr2Xoxr?si=ff8d995d0f2f441a

They've seen wars, the bottom of the ocean and even - bizarrely - been part of a boxing match.

The story of how the Parthenon Marbles actually ended up in London's British Museum is a wild tale featuring bribes, court cases and some extremely dodgy deals.

There's been a centuries-long campaign to get them back to their homeland. Now, a team of Greek-Australians have decided that the time for diplomacy is over, and a new tactic is required.

Reconstructed Ishtar Gate at Pergamon Museum in Berlin

Nefertiti Bust | Thutmose | 1345 BC, Amarna (Neues Museum Berlin)